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TRAINING PARTICIPANTS MANUAL 2024

HUMANITARIAN PROJECT CYCLE MANAGEMENT (HPCM)

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INTRODUCITON TO CONCERN WORLDWIDE AND RAPID PROGRAM

Concern Worldwide is an international humanitarian organization that has been operating in Pakistan since 2001. Since 2009, Concern has been implementing the RAPID Fund program with the support of USAID's Bureau for Humanitarian Assistance (USAID/BHA). The primary objective of RAPID is to provide lifesaving assistance to the affected population in the aftermath of natural or human-induced disasters across the country.

Working closely with the Provincial Disaster Management Authorities (PDMAs) and other humanitarian stakeholders, RAPID provides needs-based sub-grants for 3 to 6 months to national and international NGOs through a systematic short-term small grants mechanism. While RAPID's team disburses and manages the sub-award funds, the field implementation work is the responsibility of the respective sub-grantees (NGOs).

Over the past 15 years, RAPID has responded to multiple humanitarian emergencies and crises, including floods, droughts, earthquakes, the COVID-19 pandemic, and internally displaced persons (IDPs). Through these efforts, RAPID has benefited a total of 10.7 million individuals, including 50 percent women, by awarding 299 projects to 111 sub-awardees, of which 90 percent are local NGOs.

Under RAPID III (Phase III), Concern Worldwide also includes a capacity strengthening component with targeted support activities for both national NGOs and Disaster Management Authorities (DMAs). Concern has implemented humanitarian capacity strengthening activities in three provinces (Sindh, KPK, and Baluchistan) and the Gilgit-Baltistan region. A two-pronged strategy has been adopted, including trainings and institutional strengthening support. RAPID has signed MOUs with the National Institute of Disaster Management (NIDM - the training wing of NDMA), Community Worldwide Service-Asia (CWS-A), and the National Humanitarian Network (NHN) to acquire their technical services for capacity-building events. Additionally, RAPID has signed MOUs with 94 local NGOs (42 in Sindh, 18 in Baluchistan, 28 in KPK, and 6 in GB) and developed their humanitarian capacity-building plans. Summary of achievements under capacity building objective is given below:

Disaster Management Authorities: Memorandums of Understanding (MOUs) have been signed with the national disaster management authorities (NDMA) and 4 Provincial Disaster Management Authorities (PDMAs). 1768 government officials have been trained on various topics including disaster preparedness, response and simulation, forest fire prevention and mitigation, and local needs and gaps analysis. Institutional strengthening of DMAs includes the development of a Management Information System (MIS) for 3 PDMAs, the development of Disaster Response Operational Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), and the implementation of Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) guidelines. Essential equipment such as Thuraya, mobile phones, computers, scanners, and conferencing devices have been provided.

Local NGOs: Capacity and institutional strengthening support has been provided to 85 local NGOs in Sindh (39 NGOs), KPK (28 NGOs), and Baluchistan (16 NGOs). 1125 staff members have been trained on program management, system quality, and accountability systems. 67 NGOs have had their emergency response instructional procedures strengthened, with 357 manuals/guidelines (Program, HR, finance, procurement, M&E) developed for local NGOs. Essential equipment (computers, scanners, photocopiers, data storage device, printer, financial management software etc.) have also been provided to 32 local NGOs to harness their organizational capacities to better deal and respond to humanitarian disasters.

PREFACE

It is with great pleasure and a profound sense of purpose that I introduce this Field Staff Training Manual on Humanitarian Project Cycle Management (HPCM) on behalf of Concern Worldwide's RAPID Program. As the Programme Director of Concern RAPID, I am deeply committed to our mission of delivering lifesaving assistance to communities in the aftermath of disasters across Pakistan.

Concern Worldwide has been at the forefront of humanitarian action in Pakistan since 2001, responding swiftly to various emergencies with compassion and expertise. Through our RAPID Program, initiated in 2009 with the generous support of USAID's Bureau for Humanitarian Assistance (USAID/BHA), we have been able to provide critical assistance to those affected by natural or human-induced disasters across different Pakistani districts and regions.

The Executive Summary of this training manual highlights the crucial role played by Disaster Management Authorities (DMAs), as well as, local and national NGOs, in responding to emergencies. However, it also underscores the challenges they face in managing multiple disasters due to capacity constraints. To address this issue, RAPID second objective is to enhance local capacity through capacity-building support to NGOs and DMAs, leveraging Pakistan's significant national NGO base and established disaster management structure.

This reference manual serves as a practical tool for project managers, deputy managers, field coordinators, and other team members actively involved in humanitarian projects. It offers comprehensive guidance across all project phases, incorporating practical tools, scenario-based learning, and checklists to overcome implementation challenges and ensure project efficiency. Developed with funding from USAID/BHA and in collaboration with Concern Worldwide Pakistan, this manual distills industry best practices and insights from real-world experiences. The reference manual is tailored for local and national NGO personnel in Pakistan, facilitating knowledge exchange and learning through three-day training workshops. By enhancing participants' capacity in HPCM, we aim to equip them with the skills necessary to proficiently plan, execute, and manage humanitarian projects, ultimately contributing to more effective, efficient, and sustainable interventions.

Effective project management is crucial for timely assistance delivery in the humanitarian landscape. This manual provides a framework guiding practitioners through each project stage, from launch to closure, with the overarching goal of building a more resilient and compassionate Pakistan, where no one is left behind during crises.

I extend my gratitude to all those involved in the development of this manual and express my sincere hope that it will serve as a valuable resource in enhancing the capacity of humanitarian actors across Pakistan.

Warm regards,

*Mr. Amir Malik
Programme Director, Concern RAPID*

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Local and national non-governmental organizations (NGOs) and Disaster Management Authorities (DMAs) are typically the first responders to disasters. However, they often encounter challenges in managing multiple disasters due to constraints in institutional and staff capacity. Concern Worldwide's RAPID III program aims to address this issue by providing capacity-building support to local NGOs and DMAs. The primary goal is to enhance local capacity, leveraging the country's significant national NGO base and established disaster management structure, which has the potential to significantly contribute to timely and effective humanitarian preparedness and response efforts. Following the successful completion of the initial phase of capacity-building initiatives for 82 NGOs across three provinces (Balochistan, Sindh & KPK) and Gilgit-Baltistan, Concern Worldwide has been imparting advanced-level trainings for targeted humanitarian organizations.

During emergencies, all humanitarian actors and organizations manage their work through projects. Projects help fulfill promises to target communities and beneficiaries that assistance will be provided. Projects are the primary mechanism for delivering results to beneficiaries. In short, projects are the lifeblood of the emergency sector, and project management is all about planning, organizing, and managing all resources to achieve specific goals for the people worked with and for. This Field Staff Training Manual on Humanitarian Project Cycle Management (HPCM) is a practical reference tool designed for project managers, deputy managers, field coordinators, and team members actively involved in humanitarian projects. It provides guidance across all project phases, covering planning, human resource management, stakeholder engagement, risk management, quality assurance, monitoring, sustainability, and exit strategies. The manual includes practical tools, scenario-based learning, and checklists to overcome implementation challenges and ensure project efficiency.

Participants are introduced to examples and case studies tailored to the unique challenges of humanitarian projects, empowering them with skills to navigate complex operational environments. Developed with funding from the USAID/Bureau of Humanitarian Assistance (BHA) and in collaboration with Concern Worldwide Pakistan, this manual distills industry best practices and insights from real-world experiences.

Tailored for local/national NGO personnel in Pakistan, the manual serves as the foundation for three-day training workshops, facilitating knowledge exchange and learning through discussions, group work, and activities. By enhancing participants' capacity in HPCM, we aim to equip them with the skills needed to proficiently plan, execute, manage risks, communicate with a variety of stakeholders, manage quality of the project, use monitoring data for adaptive management, and close out projects addressing the needs of vulnerable populations.

Effective project management is crucial for timely assistance delivery in the humanitarian landscape. This manual provides a framework guiding practitioners through each project stage, from launch to closure, aiming to enhance the effectiveness, efficiency, and sustainability of humanitarian interventions.

Let's work together to build a more resilient and compassionate Pakistan, where no one is left behind during crises.



1. DAY I- LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Participants can define and explain humanitarian PCM, its foundation & phases, and the humanitarian principles.
- Participants understand six aspects of emergency project performance (Costs, Timescales, Quality, Scope, Risks, and Results)
- Participants can differentiate between humanitarian projects and programs.
- Participants know the critical activities for launching a project.
- Participants know about the people management skills during a humanitarian project implementation (capacity building, delegation, motivation, mediation, appraisal)

THE HUMANITARIAN PROJECT CYCLE MANAGEMENT (HPCM)

Humanitarian organizations use the Humanitarian Project Cycle Management (HPCM) method to systematically plan, carry out, monitor, and evaluate projects intended to meet the needs of vulnerable populations in emergencies. It provides a structured framework for managing projects effectively from conception to completion, ensuring that interventions are responsive, efficient, and accountable.

Planning, delegating, monitoring and control of all aspects of the project, and the motivation of those involved, to achieve specific results within the agreed expected performance targets of cost, time and scope for the people we work with them or for.

The foundation of HPCM lies in its commitment to principles such as humanity, impartiality, neutrality, and independence, which are fundamental to humanitarian action. These principles guide humanitarian organizations in delivering aid based on needs alone, without discrimination or political considerations.¹

1.1.THE HUMANITARIAN PRINCIPLES

Humanitarian principles are fundamental values that guide the actions and operations of humanitarian organizations in providing assistance and protection to people affected by crises. Let's delve into each principle with examples:

1.1.1 Humanity

This principle emphasizes preserving human dignity and alleviating suffering, irrespective of race, nationality, gender, religion, or political affiliation. Humanitarian actors prioritize the needs of individuals and communities affected by crises, aiming to save lives and alleviate suffering without discrimination.

Example: In response to a natural disaster such as an earthquake, humanitarian organizations provide emergency medical care, food, shelter, and other essential services to affected populations, regardless of their background. To ensure their needs are satisfied, they give priority to the most vulnerable people, such as children, the elderly, and people with disabilities.²

Case Study: In response to a devastating flood in a low-income country, a humanitarian organization immediately mobilizes to provide emergency relief to affected communities. Recognizing the urgency of the situation and the acute needs of survivors, the organization swiftly delivers life-saving assistance, including food, clean water, shelter, and medical care, to those most affected by the disaster. Volunteers and staff members work tirelessly around the clock, demonstrating compassion, empathy, and solidarity with the flood victims, regardless of their nationality, ethnicity, religion, or social status. By prioritizing preserving human dignity and alleviating suffering, the humanitarian organization embodies the principle of Humanity in its response to the crisis.

1.1.2 Impartiality

Impartiality requires humanitarian actors to provide assistance based on need without favoritism, bias, or discrimination. Aid is distributed according to the severity of needs, regardless of ethnicity, religion, political affiliation, or socioeconomic status.

Example: In a conflict zone where multiple ethnic groups are affected by violence and displacement, a humanitarian organization ensures that aid is distributed equitably based on assessed needs. Assistance is provided to all affected populations, regardless of their ethnic or religious background, to ensure fairness and impartiality.

Case Study: In a densely populated urban area hit by a major earthquake, a humanitarian organization launches a relief operation to provide emergency shelter materials to displaced families. Recognizing the widespread devastation and urgent need for assistance, the organization distributes shelter kits to affected households based on impartial criteria, such as the severity of damage to their homes and their vulnerability status. Assistance is provided to all eligible beneficiaries without discrimination, ensuring that those most in need receive support regardless of their background or affiliations. By applying impartiality, the organization ensures fairness and equity in aid distribution, prioritizing assistance based solely on humanitarian needs.

1.1.3 Neutrality

Neutrality involves refraining from taking sides in conflicts or engaging in activities that could be perceived as supporting one party over another. Humanitarian actors maintain neutrality to gain the trust and acceptance of all parties to a conflict, allowing them to access and assist affected populations without endangering their safety or compromising their humanitarian principles.

Example: In a civil war between two opposing factions, a humanitarian organization providing medical care operates in a manner that does not favour either side. It treats wounded combatants and civilians alike, adhering to principles of medical neutrality and ensuring access to healthcare for all, regardless of their affiliation.

Case study: In a conflict-affected region where multiple armed groups are engaged in hostilities, a humanitarian organization operates mobile medical clinics to provide emergency healthcare to civilians caught in the crossfire. Despite the complex and volatile security situation, the organization maintains strict neutrality, refraining from taking sides or engaging in activities that could be perceived as supporting any party to the conflict. Medical staff treat all patients impartially, regardless of their affiliation, ensuring that medical assistance is provided based solely on need and humanitarian principles. By upholding neutrality, the organization gains the trust and acceptance of all parties to the conflict, enabling it to access and assist vulnerable populations without endangering its staff or compromising its humanitarian mission.

1.1.4 Independence

Independence entails maintaining autonomy and freedom from external influences, enabling humanitarian organizations to make decisions based on humanitarian needs and principles rather than political, economic, or other interests. Humanitarian actors strive to operate independently to uphold their integrity, credibility, and effectiveness in assisting.

Example: A humanitarian organization conducting a relief operation in a country affected by political unrest ensures that the agendas of any government or external actor do not influence its assistance. It maintains its independence by adhering to humanitarian principles and making decisions based solely on the needs of affected populations.

By adhering to these humanitarian principles—humanity, impartiality, neutrality, and independence—humanitarian organizations uphold their commitment to serving the most vulnerable individuals and communities affected by crises while maintaining integrity, accountability, and effectiveness in their humanitarian action.

Case Study: In a country affected by political instability and government restrictions on humanitarian access, a non-governmental organization (NGO) launches a human rights advocacy campaign to raise awareness about the plight of marginalized communities and advocate for their protection and rights. Despite facing pressure and criticism from authorities, the NGO remains independent and autonomous in its actions, refusing to compromise its principles or align with political agendas. Through strategic advocacy efforts, the organization amplifies the voices of affected communities, mobilizes public support, and calls for meaningful reforms to address systemic injustices and violations of human rights. By maintaining independence, the NGO safeguards its credibility, integrity, and effectiveness in advancing humanitarian causes and promoting social justice.



Humanity



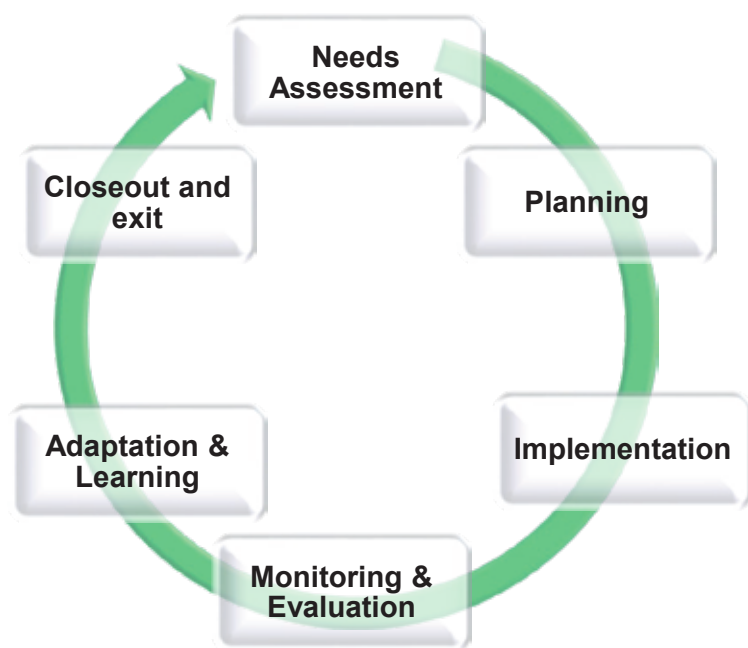
Impartiality



Neutrality



Independence



1.2. THE HUMANITARIAN PROJECT CYCLE MANAGEMENT PHASES

1.2.1 Needs Assessment

When a shock/hazard occurs, we generally observe disruption in or of access, quality, availability, awareness or use of goods and services. As a result, the satisfaction or degree of fulfilment of basic needs decreases and the affected population experiences deprivation. This leads to unmet basic needs, the actual difference between a preferred state or condition, and the actual one.

The needs assessment aims to obtain and analyze data/information to determine the current situation in the aftermath of disasters and prioritize the needs of the defined population or/and geographic area(s). This also includes which communities have been affected by the disaster, what they need to provide relief assistance quickly, and their recovery needs later.

This phase involves conducting thorough assessments to understand the needs and vulnerabilities of the affected population. It includes gathering data on demographics, health, nutrition, shelter, water, sanitation, and other essential aspects.

Example: In response to a natural disaster such as a hurricane, a humanitarian organization might conduct rapid assessments to determine the extent of damage and the immediate needs of the affected communities.

1.2.2 Planning

Organizations develop detailed project plans during the planning phase based on the findings of the needs assessment. This involves setting objectives, defining strategies, identifying resources, establishing timelines, and outlining monitoring and evaluation mechanisms.

Example: If the needs assessment identifies a lack of clean drinking water as a critical issue, the organization may plan to implement a water sanitation project, specifying the target population, locations, budget, and timeline.

1.2.3 Implementation

The planned activities are carried out in this phase according to the project plan. This involves mobilizing resources, coordinating with partners and stakeholders, managing supply chain, managing budget, managing safety & security, and delivering services or assistance to the affected population.

Example: The humanitarian organization implements the water sanitation project by constructing wells, distributing water purification tablets, and conducting hygiene awareness sessions in the affected communities.

CASE STUDIES IMPLEMENTATION PHASE OF HUMANITARIAN PROJECT CYCLE MANAGEMENT:

Case Study: Emergency Health Response in Yemen

Context: Yemen has been facing a severe humanitarian crisis due to ongoing conflict, displacement, and a collapsing health system. In response, humanitarian organizations launched emergency health projects to provide critical medical assistance to affected populations.

Implementation: Medical teams were deployed to set up mobile clinics and health facilities in conflict-affected areas, providing emergency medical care, vaccinations, maternal and child health services, and treatment for malnutrition and infectious diseases.

Challenges: Limited access to remote and insecure areas, shortages of medical supplies and qualified healthcare personnel, and funding constraints posed significant challenges to project implementation.

Successes: Despite the challenges, the emergency health response in Yemen saved countless lives, reached millions of vulnerable individuals with essential healthcare services, and contributed to reducing morbidity and mortality rates.³

Case Study: Refugee Education Program in Cox's Bazar, Bangladesh

Context: Cox's Bazar hosts one of the world's largest refugee camps, where Rohingya refugees from Myanmar have sought shelter. To address the educational needs of refugee children, humanitarian organizations implemented a comprehensive education program.

Implementation: Temporary learning centers were established within the camp, equipped with educational materials and staffed by trained teachers and facilitators. The curriculum focused on basic literacy, numeracy, life skills, and psychosocial support to promote holistic development and resilience among refugee children.

Challenges: Overcrowded learning spaces, language barriers, trauma-related issues, and limited resources posed challenges to the effective implementation of the education program. Additionally, monsoon rains and adverse weather conditions disrupted learning activities.

Successes: Despite the challenges, the refugee education program in Cox's Bazar provided access to quality education for thousands of Rohingya children, empowering them with essential knowledge and skills and offering a sense of normalcy and hope amid the hardships of displacement.⁴

Case Study: Disaster Risk Reduction Project in Nepal

Context: Nepal is prone to natural disasters such as earthquakes, floods, and landslides, which pose significant risks to vulnerable communities. Humanitarian organizations implemented a disaster risk reduction (DRR) project to enhance community resilience and preparedness.

Implementation: The project focused on community-based initiatives such as hazard mapping, early warning systems, emergency drills, and infrastructure improvements to mitigate disaster risks and enhance response capacities at the local level.

Challenges: Limited awareness and understanding of disaster risk reduction concepts, inadequate infrastructure, and socio-economic vulnerabilities hindered the effectiveness of DRR interventions. Additionally, frequent political instability and bureaucratic hurdles delayed project implementation.

Successes: Despite the challenges, the DRR project in Nepal empowered communities to identify and address local hazards, strengthen disaster preparedness and response mechanisms, and build safer and more resilient livelihoods. The project reduced disaster-related losses and saved lives during subsequent natural disasters.

These case studies highlight the complexities, successes, and challenges encountered during the implementation phase of humanitarian projects, emphasizing the importance of adaptive management, community engagement, and multi-stakeholder collaboration in achieving sustainable impact and resilience in crisis-affected contexts.⁵



1.2.4 Monitoring and Evaluation

Monitoring is a primary means to verify how well a project is being implemented, identify challenges that may hinder results and build an understanding of what it achieved. Monitoring data/information is used to make the best decisions to improve and effectively deliver high impact, accountable, equitable project for good value. Monitoring involves systematically tracking the progress of project activities to ensure they are implemented as planned and to identify any challenges or deviations. Evaluation involves assessing the project's effectiveness, efficiency, and impact against its objectives.

Example: Monitoring activities may include regular site visits to inspect the condition of wells and collect feedback from beneficiaries. At the same time, evaluation may involve conducting surveys to measure changes in water quality and hygiene practices among the target population.

1.2.5 Adaptation and Learning

As humanitarian needs and situations change, and as our understanding of complex problems evolves, humanitarian agencies must be able to adapt. Based on the findings from monitoring and evaluation, organizations adapt their approaches and strategies as necessary to improve project performance and outcomes. Learning from both successes and failures is essential for continuous improvement. Learning helps us to understand what does and does not work and is critical to the success of project.

Example: If the monitoring data reveals that specific communities are not effectively using the provided water purification tablets, the organization may revise its hygiene promotion strategies to communicate the importance of proper usage better.

Organizations can eventually contribute to more effective humanitarian assistance by using the Humanitarian Project Cycle Management approach to ensure their interventions are well-planned, carried out effectively, and responsive to the changing needs of affected populations.

Stringer/Reuters



1.2.6 Project Closure and Exit.

Humanitarian project closure and exit activities involve systematically winding down project operations while ensuring that the project's objectives are met, lessons are learned, and the community's capacity to sustainably address its needs is strengthened.

Project closure is of great importance, but it is often overlooked and/or under-resourced. With pressures to move on to new projects and reassign staff members to other activities, the most practical way to ensure a complete project closure is to include a project closure plan in the project plan.

Example: A humanitarian organization has implemented a project aimed at providing clean water access to a remote village in a developing country. Throughout the project duration, they have drilled wells, installed water purification systems, conducted hygiene education workshops, and established a local water management committee to oversee maintenance.

Organisation shall plan to formally handover the supervision / maintenance of the wells and water purification system to the Public Health & Engineering Department and also provide repair maintenance tools, materials to the water management committee, and can also organize Hygiene Education training to the schoolteachers, local councilors, and lady health workers, and handover the training materials to these institutions. Organizations shall also prepare project closeout meetings with the local administration and the respective village committees.



1.3. SIX ASPECTS OF EMERGENCY PROJECT PERFORMANCE

Six variables (performance targets) must be controlled in a project: timescales, Costs, Quality, Scope, Benefits, and Risk. These are also known as the six aspects of project performance⁶.

Humanitarian project performance aspects ensure that projects are executed effectively and achieve their intended outcomes. Here's an explanation of each element with examples:

1.3.1 Time

Refers to the schedule or timeline within which project activities are planned and executed. Delays in project implementation can hinder the delivery of assistance to affected populations and may exacerbate their suffering.

Example: In a refugee camp setup project, the construction of shelters, restrooms, and other infrastructure must be completed within a specified timeframe to accommodate the incoming refugees before adverse weather conditions.

1.3.2 Cost

Cost involves the financial resources required to carry out project activities, including expenses for materials, labor, logistics, and overhead. Managing costs efficiently ensures that available funding is utilized effectively and transparently. The project has to be affordable and, though we may start out with a particular budget in mind, there will be many factors which can lead to overspending and, perhaps, some opportunities to cut costs.

Example: A food distribution project in a famine-affected region must carefully manage costs to procure and transport food supplies within budget constraints while ensuring that beneficiaries receive adequate nutrition.

1.3.3 Quality

Quality refers to the standard or level of excellence in delivering project outputs and outcomes. Ensuring high-quality interventions is essential for meeting the needs of affected populations and safeguarding their well-being. The project's services or goods must be fit for purpose.

Example: A healthcare project providing medical treatment to refugees must ensure that healthcare facilities are equipped with trained staff and appropriate medical supplies and adhere to clinical protocols to deliver quality services and prevent the spread of diseases.

1.3.4 Scope:

Scope defines the project's boundaries and objectives, including the range of activities, deliverables, and outcomes to be achieved. Effectively managing scope helps maintain focus and clarity throughout the project lifecycle. What exactly will the project deliver? There must be agreement on the project's scope, and the Project Manager needs to have a detailed understanding of what is and what is not within the scope.

Example: An education project aimed at providing schooling for refugee children may have a defined scope that includes curriculum development, teacher training, provision of educational materials, and establishment of learning centers within the refugee camps.

1.3.5 Benefits

Benefits refer to the positive impacts or outcomes generated by the project for the affected populations. Understanding and maximizing benefits is essential for ensuring humanitarian interventions improve communities' well-being and resilience in crises.

Example: A livelihoods project providing vocational training and income-generating opportunities for internally displaced persons (IDPs) aims to empower beneficiaries to support themselves economically, thereby reducing their dependency on humanitarian aid and enhancing their self-reliance.

1.3.6 Risk

Risk encompasses potential threats or uncertainties that may impact the successful delivery of project objectives, such as security concerns, logistical challenges, environmental hazards, or political instability. Identifying, assessing, and mitigating risks are essential for minimizing disruptions and ensuring project resilience.

Example: A humanitarian organization conducting a relief distribution operation in a conflict-affected area must assess security risks to its staff and beneficiaries, implement appropriate security measures, and establish contingency plans to manage potential threats such as armed violence or looting.

By considering and effectively managing these six performance aspects—time, cost, quality, scope, benefits, and risk—humanitarian organizations can enhance their projects' efficiency, effectiveness, and impact, ultimately improving outcomes for vulnerable populations in crises.



1.4. THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN A HUMANITARIAN PROJECT AND A HUMANITARIAN PROGRAM

While both humanitarian projects and humanitarian programs aim to address the needs of vulnerable populations in crises, they differ in scope, duration, and complexity.⁷

Here's an explanation of the difference between a humanitarian project and a humanitarian program, along with examples:

1.4.1 A Humanitarian Project

A humanitarian project is a discrete, time-bound intervention designed to achieve specific objectives within a limited timeframe. It typically addresses a particular need or problem that affected populations face and involves a defined set of activities and outcomes. Humanitarian projects are often implemented in response to acute emergencies or immediate needs, such as natural disasters, conflicts, or disease outbreaks.

Beneficiary communities invest their time, emergency resources in the projects, and they trust the projects to help them solve their challenges. Projects can differ in size and scope (from village level to a huge emergency response project like RAPID III). Despite the differences in scopes and sizes, all well-run and successful projects have one thing in common: an efficient project manager contributing to the overall success of the project.

What are all these projects trying to do? Projects help us keep our promises. We promise communities and beneficiaries that we will help. Projects are our main mechanism for delivering results to beneficiaries. In short, projects are the lifeblood of the emergency sector, and project management is all about planning, organizing, and managing all resources to achieve specific goals for the people we work with and for.

Humanitarian organizations are responding to natural disasters and working in conflict zones to save lives and improve access to humanitarian assistance. You might have experiences of these. What is common is that all organizations manage their work through projects. Donors fund projects and expect to deliver the results.

These projects are characterized by their relatively short duration, clear objectives, and specific deliverables.

Example: The project distributes emergency food aid to internally displaced persons (IDPs) in the aftermath of a conflict. It aims to provide immediate relief to the affected population by delivering food parcels containing essential items such as rice, lentils, and cooking oil. The project's duration may span a few weeks to several months until the IDPs' immediate food needs are met.

1.4.2 The Humanitarian Program

A humanitarian program is a broader and more comprehensive initiative to address multiple interconnected needs or issues affected populations face over an extended period. It involves a series of coordinated projects and activities designed to achieve broader humanitarian objectives.

Humanitarian programs are often implemented in protracted crises or complex emergencies where multiple needs exist across different sectors, such as health, education, livelihoods, and protection.

These programs typically require longer-term planning, coordination, and resource mobilization to address systemic issues and promote sustainable solutions.

Example: Refugee assistance program in a conflict-affected region. The program encompasses various projects and activities to address the diverse needs of refugees, including shelter provision, healthcare services, education support, livelihood opportunities, and psychosocial support. It involves long-term engagement with multiple stakeholders, coordination with government authorities and other humanitarian actors, and continuous monitoring and evaluation to ensure effectiveness and sustainability. The program's duration may span several years, reflecting the protracted nature of the refugee crisis and the need for sustained assistance and protection.

In summary, while humanitarian projects focus on delivering targeted interventions to address immediate needs in a specific timeframe, humanitarian programs adopt a more comprehensive and sustained approach to address multifaceted challenges affected populations face over an extended period. Both play vital roles in humanitarian response, with projects offering immediate relief and programs promoting long-term resilience and recovery.

1.5. STEPS TO LAUNCH A HUMANITARIAN PROJECT

The Project Director / Project Manager shall work on the following eight steps before commencing or formally launching a Humanitarian project.

Let's elaborate on each of these steps with examples from the launch of a hypothetical humanitarian project aimed at providing emergency medical assistance to a refugee population in a conflict-affected area:

1.5.1 Define Your Objective

Provide emergency medical care and support to refugees in conflict-affected areas to improve health outcomes and reduce mortality rates.

Outputs: Establish mobile medical clinics, deploy medical teams, procure essential medical supplies, conduct health assessments, provide treatment and referrals, and promote health education and awareness.

1.5.2 Establish Your Tasks and Work Plan

Work Plan: Develop a detailed timeline outlining key activities, milestones, dependencies, and responsibilities.

Example: Week 1—Conduct needs assessment and procure medical supplies. Weeks 2-3—Recruit and train medical staff and set up mobile clinics. Weeks 4-8—Deploy medical teams, conduct health screenings, provide treatment. Ongoing—Monitor and evaluate program performance and adjust activities as needed.

1.5.3 Determine Your Budget

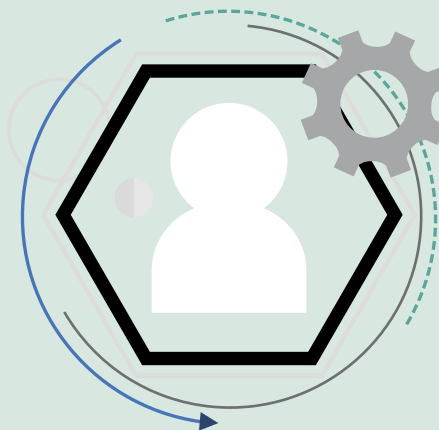
Budget: Prepare a detailed monthly budget covering operational and programmatic expenses, including personnel, supplies, transportation, logistics, training, and overhead costs.

Example: Monthly Budget Breakdown - Personnel salaries: PKR 900,000, Medical supplies: PKR 250,000, Transportation: PKR 140,000, Training of new team: PKR 100,000, Overhead costs: PKR 100,000.

1.5.4 Identify Risks

Risk Identification: Develop a risk matrix identifying potential risks, their likelihood, impact, and mitigation strategies.

Example: Risks—security threats, shortage of medical supplies, logistical challenges, staff burnout. Mitigation Strategies—implement security protocols, diversify supply sources, strengthen logistics coordination, and provide staff support and debriefing.



KEY COMPETENCIES AND ACCOUNTABILITIES OF A HUMANITARIAN PROJECT MANAGER

Whether titled Project Director or Project Manager, the specific role depends upon the project organogram or organizational hierarchy. Below are some of the required competencies for the project manager:

- *Responsible for the success of the project.*
- *Collaborate to ensure that all project work is being done and completed.*
- *Ensure adherence to humanitarian principles, standards, and ethics.*
- *Provide cross-functional oversight (including supply chain, safety/security, monitoring, etc.).*
- *Possess competencies encompassing both soft and hard skills.*
- *Effective people management skills.*
- *Establish and maintain an amiable work culture.*
- *Practice stewardship of project resources.*
- *Uphold a duty of care to all involved parties.*
- *Hold oneself accountable for project outcomes.*

IN CASE THE PROJECT PROPOSAL, LFM, AND BUDGETS ARE ALREADY APPROVED BY THE DONOR, THEN MAY WE HAVE DIFFERENT START-UP ACTIVITIES LIKE THOSE GIVEN BELOW.

- *Gather emergency project documents.*
- *Understanding stakeholders and their management.*
- *Structure the project organization.*
- *Recruit and mobilize project team members.*
- *Establish the project's operational strategies and agree on procedures.*
- *Communication Management.*
- *Risks Management,*
- *Quality Management Set up system /system/procedures for support functions*

1.5.5 Establish a Performing Team

Team Assessment: Assess staff skills, strengths, and areas for improvement to build a cohesive and complementary team.
Example: Medical team composition - Doctors, nurses, pharmacists, and support staff with experience in emergency medicine, trauma care, and cross-cultural communication. Provide training and capacity-building opportunities to enhance team effectiveness.

1.5.6 Promote Collaboration

Inter-departmental Meetings: Establish regular meetings to facilitate communication, coordination, and collaboration among project teams and departments.

Example: Weekly coordination meetings involving medical, logistics, finance, liaison officer and monitoring and evaluation teams to discuss progress, challenges, and priorities. Daily briefings to exchange tasks and responsibilities and address emerging issues.

1.5.7 Use Tools

Checklists and Reporting Schedules: Develop standardized checklists, reporting templates, and schedules to ensure consistency, accountability, and timely information exchange.

Example: Daily checklist for medical teams to track patient consultations, treatments, and referrals. Weekly reporting schedule for submitting program updates, achievements, and challenges.

1.5.8 Organizing a Launch Meeting

Launch Meeting: Convene a kick-off meeting to officially launch the project, communicate objectives, roles, and expectations, and foster team spirit and motivation.

Example: Agenda - Introduction and project overview, presentation of objectives and work plan, team introductions, discussion of roles and responsibilities, Q&A session, team-building activities.

By following these steps, the humanitarian project can be effectively launched, ensuring objectives clarity, activities alignment, efficient resource allocation, proactive risk management, cohesive team dynamics, and effective collaboration among project stakeholders.



1.6. PEOPLE MANAGEMENT SKILLS DURING A HUMANITARIAN PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION

People management skills are essential for effectively leading and coordinating humanitarian projects, particularly in dynamic and challenging environments.⁸ Let's explore how different aspects of people management skills⁹ are applied during humanitarian project implementation, with examples:¹⁰

1.6.1 Capacity Building

Definition: Capacity building involves identifying and developing project staff and partners' knowledge, skills, and abilities to enhance their effectiveness and resilience in delivering project objectives.

Example: In a refugee education project, capacity building may involve providing training sessions for local teachers on pedagogical techniques, classroom management, and psychosocial support to improve their ability to meet the diverse learning needs of refugee children.

examples of free online training platforms for humanitarian personnel

<https://www.humanitarianlibrary.org/collection/free-online-training-courses-humanitarian-settings>

<https://youtu.be/RmP0hp0iogA?si=hr5kKrG-mg0ZXrR1>



1.6.2 Delegation

Definition: Delegation involves assigning tasks and responsibilities to team members based on their skills, expertise, and capacity while providing necessary support and oversight to ensure successful task completion.

Example: In a disaster response project, the project manager delegates the coordination of logistics and procurement tasks to a designated logistics officer, empowering them to liaise with suppliers, track inventory, and ensure the timely delivery of relief supplies.

Case Study:

In a disaster response project following a major earthquake, the project manager realizes the importance of effective delegation to manage the overwhelming workload and ensure the timely delivery of emergency aid to affected communities. The manager delegates specific tasks such as logistics coordination, medical triage, shelter distribution, and community outreach to different team members based on their expertise and capacity. By empowering team members to take ownership of their responsibilities and providing necessary support and guidance, the project manager successfully coordinates a comprehensive and efficient response, reaching thousands of affected individuals with life-saving assistance within days of the disaster.

1.6.3 Motivation

Definition: Motivation involves inspiring and empowering team members to remain committed, engaged, and enthusiastic about their work, especially in challenging and high-pressure environments.

Example: In a health outreach project, the project manager recognizes and celebrates the achievements of frontline healthcare workers who have demonstrated exceptional dedication and compassion in providing medical care to vulnerable communities, boosting their morale and motivation.

Case Study:

In a refugee assistance project operating in a protracted crisis setting, the project leader recognizes the importance of maintaining high motivation among project staff who are often confronted with challenging and emotionally taxing situations. The leader implements various strategies to boost team morale, including regular team meetings to celebrate successes and acknowledge individual contributions, providing opportunities for professional development and skill-building, and fostering a supportive and inclusive team culture. Despite the demanding nature of their work, project staff feel valued, supported, and motivated to continue making a positive impact on the lives of refugees, resulting in sustained commitment and dedication to the project's goals.

1.6.4 Mediation

Definition: Mediation involves facilitating constructive communication and resolving conflicts or disputes among team members or stakeholders to maintain positive working relationships and foster a supportive team environment.

Example: In a community-based project, the project leader mediates a disagreement between two community leaders over allocating resources, listening to both perspectives, facilitating dialogue, and finding a mutually acceptable solution that addresses the needs and concerns of both parties.



Case Study:

In a humanitarian project aimed at providing educational support to children in a conflict-affected area, tensions arise among project staff from different cultural backgrounds, leading to communication breakdowns and interpersonal conflicts. The project manager recognizes the need for mediation to address these issues and restore harmony within the team. The manager facilitates mediation sessions, providing a safe and inclusive space for staff members to express their concerns, listen to each other's perspectives, and find mutually acceptable solutions. Through open dialogue and constructive problem-solving, the team resolves their differences, strengthens their relationships, and refocuses their collective efforts on achieving the project's objectives.

1.6.5 Appraisal

Definition: Appraisal involves providing constructive feedback, evaluating performance, and recognizing achievements to support individual growth, learning, and professional development within the team.

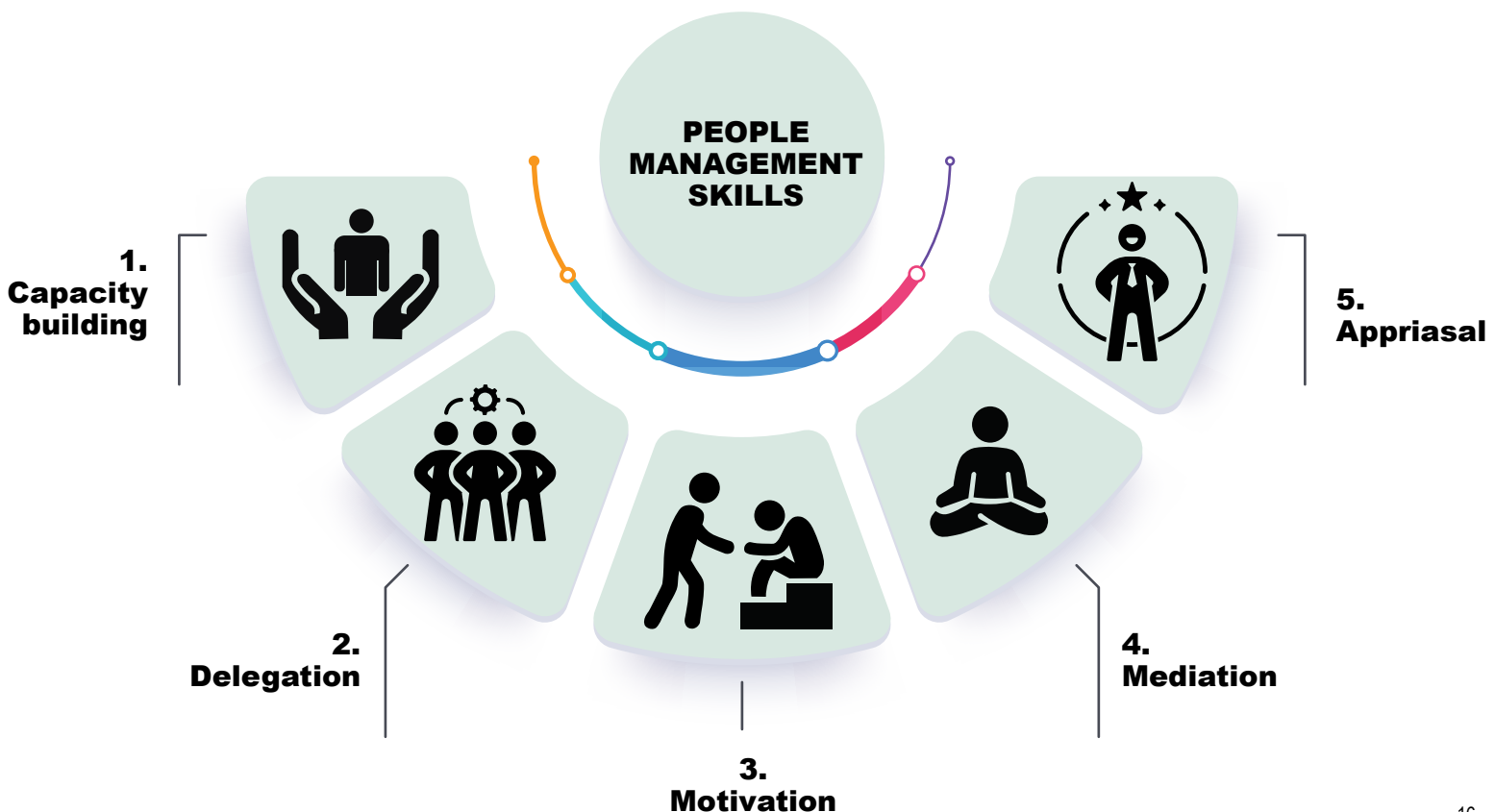
Example: In a livelihoods program, the project coordinator conducts regular performance appraisals with project staff, discussing their contributions, strengths, areas for improvement, and career aspirations and collaboratively setting development goals and action plans.

By effectively applying these people management skills—capacity building, delegation, motivation, mediation, and appraisal—project managers and leaders can nurture a skilled, motivated, and cohesive team, enhance individual and collective performance, and maximize the impact and sustainability of humanitarian projects.

Case Study:

In a public health project addressing malnutrition among children in a refugee camp, the project coordinator conducts regular performance appraisals with frontline health workers to assess their effectiveness in delivering nutrition interventions and counseling caregivers.

During the appraisal meetings, the coordinator provides constructive feedback on areas of strength and areas for improvement, acknowledges staff's dedication and commitment, and collaboratively sets goals for professional development and skill enhancement. By recognizing and nurturing the talents and contributions of individual team members, the project coordinator fosters a culture of continuous learning and improvement, ultimately enhancing the quality and impact of the project's services.



1.7. SCENARIOS / ROLE PLAYS

These role-play scenarios offer opportunities for participants to practice essential skills and competencies relevant to the implementation phase of humanitarian projects, including coordination, communication, negotiation, problem-solving, and staff management, fostering experiential learning and skill development in a simulated humanitarian context.



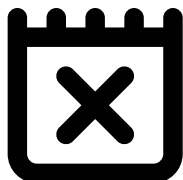
Logistics Coordination

Scenario: You are the logistics coordinator for a humanitarian project delivering emergency relief supplies to a remote disaster-affected area. Your task is coordinating the transportation, warehousing, and distribution of relief items, including food, water, shelter materials, and medical supplies. However, you encounter challenges like road closures, limited transport availability, and unpredictable weather conditions. Role-play the coordination efforts with your team members, local authorities, and transport partners to ensure timely aid delivery to affected communities while overcoming logistical obstacles.



Community Engagement

Scenario: You are a community mobilization officer responsible for engaging with affected populations and local stakeholders in a refugee camp setting. Your goal is to build trust, gather feedback, and promote community participation in project activities, such as health awareness campaigns, hygiene promotion, and livelihood support programs. Role-play interactions with community leaders, women's groups, and youth associations to identify priorities, address concerns, and mobilize support for project interventions, fostering ownership and sustainability within the community.



Conflict Resolution

Scenario: You are a project manager overseeing a humanitarian project in a conflict-affected area where tensions arise between different ethnic groups over access to project resources and services. Your role is to mediate disputes, promote dialogue, and prevent conflicts from escalating, ensuring the safety and security of project staff and beneficiaries. Role-play negotiations with community leaders, elders, and local authorities to find mutually acceptable solutions, build trust, and maintain neutrality and impartiality in addressing grievances and resolving conflicts.



Monitoring and Evaluation

Scenario: You are a monitoring and evaluation officer responsible for assessing the impact and effectiveness of a livelihoods program implemented in a rural farming community. Your task is to collect data, conduct surveys, and analyze project outcomes to measure progress towards program objectives and identify lessons learned and areas for improvement. Role-play interactions with project beneficiaries, local partners, and government officials to gather feedback, validate findings, and communicate key findings and recommendations for program adaptation and refinement.



Staff Support and Well-being

Scenario: You are a project coordinator overseeing a team of field staff working in a high-stress environment with limited resources and challenging working conditions. You provide guidance, support, and care for your team members, ensuring their well-being, motivation, and professional development. Role-play conversations with project staff to address their concerns, recognize their contributions and provide opportunities for skill-building, self-care, and resilience-building activities to enhance team cohesion and effectiveness amidst adversity.

1.8 MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONNAIRE - DAY I

Q1. What is the primary objective of Humanitarian Project Cycle Management (HPCM)?

- a) To maximize profits for humanitarian organizations
 - b) To systematically plan, implement, monitor, and evaluate projects for vulnerable populations in emergencies
 - c) To promote political agendas in crisis-affected areas
 - d) To discriminate against specific populations based on ethnicity or religion
- correct answer
1. b) To systematically plan, implement, monitor, and evaluate projects for vulnerable populations in emergencies

Q2. Which of the following is NOT one of the humanitarian principles guiding HPCM?

- a) Humanity
 - b) Impartiality
 - c) Profitability
 - d) Neutrality
- correct answer
2. c) Profitability

Q3. Which principle emphasizes providing assistance based solely on need without favoritism?

- a) Neutrality
 - b) Impartiality
 - c) Humanity
 - d) Independence
- correct answer
3. b) Impartiality

Q4. What is the main focus of the Needs Assessment phase in HPCM?

- a) Evaluating project outcomes
 - b) Identifying vulnerabilities and needs of affected populations
 - c) Establishing project timelines
 - d) Allocating financial resources
- correct answer
4. b) Identifying vulnerabilities and needs of affected populations

Q5. Which aspect of project performance refers to the standard or level of excellence in delivering project outputs and outcomes?

- a) Cost
 - b) Quality
 - c) Risk
 - d) Scope
- correct answer
5. b) Quality

Q6. How do humanitarian projects differ from humanitarian programs?

- a) Projects are broader and more comprehensive than programs
 - b) Projects address systemic issues, while programs focus on specific needs
 - c) Projects are time-bound interventions, while programs are more long-term and comprehensive
 - d) Projects require longer-term planning compared to programs
- correct answer
6. c) Projects are time-bound interventions, while programs are more long-term and comprehensive

Q7. What is the purpose of establishing tasks and work plans in launching a humanitarian project?

- a) To define project objectives
 - b) To determine the project budget
 - c) To develop a timeline for project activities
 - d) To identify potential risks
- correct answer
7. c) To develop a timeline for project activities

Q 8. Which people management skill involves identifying and developing the knowledge and skills of project staff?

- a) Delegation
 - b) Motivation
 - c) Capacity building
 - d) Mediation
- correct answer
8. c) Capacity building

Q 9. In the context of people management skills, what does delegation entail?

- a) Providing constructive feedback to team members
 - b) Assigning tasks and responsibilities to team members based on their skills
 - c) Resolving conflicts among team members
 - d) Recognizing and celebrating the achievements of team members
- correct answer
9. b) Assigning tasks and responsibilities to team members based on their skills

Q 10. What is the main purpose of conducting regular performance appraisals with project staff?

- a) To discourage staff and lower morale
 - b) To recognize and acknowledge staff's dedication and commitment
 - c) To assign blame for project failures
 - d) To ignore staff contributions and achievements
- Correct answer
10. b) To recognize and acknowledge staff's dedication and commitment



DAY II

- Participants can interpret and use project documents checklists, detailed implementation plans, Gantt charts, risk management matrices, human resource plan checklist, procurement plans, safety and security checklists, and distribution plans.
- Participants discuss and deliberate about adaptive management during project implementation.
- Participants can apply inclusion criteria (AGDM markers) and the “Do No Harm Approach” across different phases of Humanitarian Project Management, ensuring projects are implemented sensitively to diverse stakeholder needs and perspectives.

2. VARIOUS TOOLS USED IN THE IMPLEMENTATION OF HUMANITARIAN PROJECTS

Project management is essential in humanitarian responses. The humanitarian sector largely runs on projects, and funding proposals are based on projects. Our work satisfies all the traditional definitions of a project, including a defined scope, a timetable, and a set of allocated resources (financial, human, etc.). However, managing projects in the context of humanitarian responses is extremely challenging.

There is a lack of consistent information, and the situation unfolds with surprises, so you need to act quickly and ensure good documentation. Consultation with senior management and your donors is the key. Consequently, project management will increase, not decrease, in importance. You need to be able to use a wider variety of tools with ease and proficiency.

As a project manager involved in a humanitarian response, you can use various tools designed for specific settings. The tricky part is that responding to a crisis effectively requires careful usage and adaptation. You won't have to change or adapt as much when you're not during a crisis, like when you're working on recovery or rehabilitation.

Here we are introducing some of these helpful project management tools. The list is of course, not exhaustive, and there might be some other good tools, techniques, and variations used by other organizations, or individual managers and trainers, and there is also information Technology based innovation, supporting the sector, which might also be very handy in different situations.



what is project implementation?

Implementation means carrying out your projects according to the plans you've made and in line with humanitarian principles and approaches, as well as taking cross-cutting issues into consideration, and applying best practice, technical approaches appropriate for the context.

2.1 PROJECT DOCUMENTS CHECKLIST:

Finding all the key documents that describe the project and its commitments should be one of your initial tasks as a newly hired project manager. These documents will be your go-to resources; they should form the basis of your project's planning, compliance, and activity monitoring.

Below is a list of documents that most project managers should read. (If you aren't familiar with any project documents, don't hesitate to inquire with the design team and upper management.)¹¹

2.1.1 The Technical proposal

The technical proposal document lays out the background, describes the problem, and identifies the people and places that are impacted, and project is designed to support improve the situation. In it, you should detail your intended outcomes, steps to get there, inputs, and indicators of success. To accomplish the project's intended results, it lays out the plan for doing so.

Although it is an essential reference, the proposal does not give you all the information you need to handle the project independently. It could detail partners, their functions, and the planned organizational structure. Although this is helpful, it needs to be double-checked to ensure it's still suitable for achieving the project goals.

2.1.2 The Logical Framework Matrix

A logical framework, often known as a "log frame," summarizes the key points included in some proposals. The log frame lays out the project's path to completion. It contains assumptions pertaining to your project's outcomes, goals, and activities; indicators, which measure progress; and means of verification, which are sources of information and methods used to demonstrate progress.

2.1.3 The Project Budget / Financial Plan

Expenditure for the technical proposal's suggested activities can be found in the budget. You can use the donor's money better if you study the budget carefully.

Expenditures will cover Budget line items that have been approved - major expense categories can differ from donor to donor. The status of expenses can be tracked using the major groupings.

Each authorized line item has its associated costs in a comprehensive budget. The total amount allotted and the cost per unit are detailed in this document.

Cost share, also known as match funding, is your NGOs financial investment in the project. A monetary or "in kind" donation could suffice. Each expense category and its funding source will be detailed in the budget.

2.1.4 The Budget Notes

Detailed information regarding the budget can be found in the budget notes. They need to clarify the budget's unit costing methodology, the nature of the costs, and how many units were purchased.

2.1.5 Monitoring and Evaluation Plan

An M&E Plan or Evaluation and Monitoring strategy is part of some proposals. Here is a rundown of everything you need to gather, examine, and report to evaluate the project's performance, impact, and progress.

2.1.6 Partnership agreement, subcontracting, or any other type of agreement involving stakeholders.

It is common practice to sign sub granting or partnership agreements while a project is still in the design phase. The project partners (in case of a joint venture or a consortium) have agreed upon certain rights and responsibilities in these agreements. Agreement duration, required payments and funds, reporting and evaluation, general provisions, principles of conduct, confidentiality, conflicts of interest, dispute resolution, and countless other issues are typically addressed. Partners can hold each other to their word and resolve any disagreements that may arise with the help of these agreements.

Get all your partners to sign contracts right when the project starts if you haven't already. (like Parents Teachers Committee, village Council, WASH Committee, Livestock department)

2.1.7 The Grant Agreement

Before the project (and any associated expenditures) can commence, this legally enforceable agreement between your organisation and the donor must be signed. The rules and regulations, as well as our responsibilities to the donor, are outlined in contracts known as grant agreements. Read this important document carefully; it lays out the groundwork for complying with the contract.

2.2 DETAILED IMPLEMENTATION PLAN (DIP).

Project implementation, or project execution, is completing tasks to deliver a project successfully. These tasks are initially described in the project document / proposal, a comprehensive document covering all project management areas. However, a secondary action plan, a detailed implementation plan, should be created to help team members and project managers better execute and track the project.

A detailed implementation plan is a document that describes the necessary steps for executing a project. It breaks down the project implementation process by defining the timeline, the teams, and the resources needed.¹²

2.3 GNATT CHARTS

A Gantt chart is a horizontal bar chart used in project management to visually represent a project plan over time. Gantt charts typically show the timeline and status—as well as who's responsible—for each task in the project.

Here's a quick look at the details a Gantt chart enables you to capture briefly:



- *How a project breaks down into tasks?*
- *When will each task begin and end?*
- *How long each task will take?*
- *Who's assigned to each task?*
- *How do tasks relate to and depend on each other?*
- *When do essential meetings, approvals, or deadlines need to happen?*
- *How work is progressing in a project?*
- *The entire project schedule is from start to finish.*

In other words, a Gantt chart is a super-simple way to communicate what it will take to deliver a project on time and within budget. That means keeping your project team and stakeholders on the same page from the get-go is much easier.¹³

Example:

Details of Activity	Target	Quarters								Responsibility
		Q 1	Q 2	Q 3	Q 4	Q5	Q6	Q7	Q8	
Signing of Grant Agreement										Programme Director
Hiring of Project Team										Project Manager
Development of detailed implementation plan, M&E plan and reporting templates										M&E Manager
Prepare for and conduct Initial Skills/ Needs Assessment, site surveys										Project Manager, M&E Manager
Developing strategy and material for contemporary knowledge about STEM also related to curriculum defined by the Ministry of Education and training videos tutorials for female teachers and girls										Education teams, Field Officer & Project Manager
Organize orientation meetings with district MEB authorities, PITE Management, teachers and students										Project Manager and field officers
Preparation of uploading of online material and provide constant updates										Project Manager and field officers, technical team
Developing advocacy and IEC material, advocacy networks, and policy advocacy initiatives										Education institutions Management and trainings teams, Field Officer & Project Manager
Selection and induction of teachers and students										Project Manager and field officers
Rollout of gender inclusion in STEM campaigning										TKF Country office, Field Officer & Project Manager
Procurement of desktops, smart TVs, tablets and digital media										Education Institutions' Management & trainings teams, Field Officer & Project Manager, Finance Manager
Establishing TRCs for learning and training										Education Institutions' Management, Field Officer & Project Manager, Finance Manager
Arranging seminars for teachers and students about women in STEM industries										Field Officers & Project Manager
Institute monitoring mechanisms to gauge improvement in inclusion and promotion of women in STEM										Project Manager, Field Officers
Prepare for and institute end line survey and final evaluation										M&E Manager, External Evaluator



2.4 RISK ASSESSMENT AND MANAGEMENT MATRIX

Risks in the humanitarian project management are unexpected events that may or may not occur and impact the project outcome.

According to the Project Management Institute (PMI), analyzing and managing risks is a critical practice in project management. It improves the chances of successful project completion while reducing the consequences of any risk. Risks can appear related to any aspect of a project, including the budget, resources, processes, or technology, to name just a few. While it can be easy to assume that all risks have negative consequences, it's essential to understand that positive risks can also occur during the project life cycle.

A risk assessment matrix (sometimes called a risk control matrix) is used during the risk assessment stage of project planning. It identifies and captures the likelihood of project risks and evaluates the potential damage or interruption they cause.¹⁴

Example CTP Risk matrix template¹⁵

Purpose: Risk analysis represents an integral part of any emergency response design and implementation, especially in complex environments. Risk analysis and mitigation measures should be planned well ahead by programme team and be considered throughout the whole project cycle.

How to complete the tool: Identify all possible risks after consulting with local authorities, representatives from Red Cross/Red Crescent branches, community leaders and beneficiaries, local staff and volunteers.

Risks are classified under 3 broad categories: contextual, programmatic and institutional.

List as many as are relevant to your context. Rank their likelihood from 1 low to 5 high and then identify the likely impact of each risk. Again rank the likelihood 1-5. Use this information to feed into TOOL 3.1.4.2 Risk Register Template which will ask you to identify your planned actions to take control and mitigate against each risk.

CASH TRANSFERRING PROJECT :

RISK MITIGATION MATRIX

Risk Description	Probability (1. Low... 5. High)	Impact *1. Low... 5 high)	Mitigation Measures	Risks Owner
Programmatic Risks:				
Greater needs and limited numbers of beneficiaries – risk of local conflicts	low	Low	Beneficiary and village targeting criteria will be strictly followed by ORGANIZATION staff, the criteria will be displayed in Social Mobilization activities and community meetings after completion of assessment. (For Cash Assistance staff will not disclose the criteria with the beneficiaries to find out most marginalized and most vulnerable affected communities).	Field Officers
Demand for the addition of more UCs from community or Government or political pressure	Low	Low	ORGANIZATION has already coordinated, UCs are allocated and endorsed the need from Deputy Commissioner, ORGANIZATION will take all the relevant stakeholder on board and will involve the communities to reduce the political pressure.	Project Manager
Due to lack of coordination among NGOs working in the area/ Govt than there might be a chance of duplication in the area i.e. Duplication of intervention efforts in same UCs, villages,	Low	Medium	Proper coordinated effort shall be put in place, ORGANIZATION will continue to coordinate with the relevant authorities throughout project implementation so that the relevant authorities are aware about the entitlements, criteria for assistance and to avoid duplication of assistance.	
Formation of community groups / Committees with limited awareness on role and responsibilities, no formal meeting can be conducted for committee formation. As a result, our ability to mobilize the village committee will be compromised	Medium	Medium	- Village committee meeting will be called in open places or camps site where people are migrated. - Meeting frequency will very limited and nomination of meeting participants will be reduced to minimum	Project officers
Beneficiaries do not have CNICs or invalid CNIC. Though it will be less number of beneficiary who might not have CNIC, valid CNIC or copy of CNIC	Low	High	Vulnerable families in the targeted areas will be reconfirmed through social welfare department / Village committee members and their identification will be verified on undertaking form duly signed and verified by community head or at least majority of the community can confirm. Payment via printed vouchers can be made that will be duly signed by Project Manager / ORGANIZATION.	Project officers
There is risk that selection criterion for cash assistance may be disclosed to beneficiaries at final assessment of beneficiaries. As a result of this everyone will share info accordingly to selection criterion.	low	Medium	Staff member will be strictly informed to don't disclosure any information of beneficiaries' selection until finalization of beneficiary registration list should have been produced. The selection criterion shall be shared with community once registration is completed or at the time of voucher distribution, this will reduce the fake cases.	Project manager
Communication problems (Language Barrier) in Social Mobilization activities	Low	Low	ORGANIZATION will hire local staff and involve the community in social mobilization activities to ensure that message has been communicated clearly and effectively. The key messages, program details and information will be displayed on banner in local/National (understandable) language.	Project officers
Systems/Operational Risks:				
Lack of professional Human resources in local level	low	Low	ORGANIZATION will Advertise job position in local newspapers and will inform local NGOs/CBOs and shared advertisement with different NGOs and groups for hiring of committed and qualified staff. ORGANIZATION may hire its old staff or transfer existing staff having humanitarian expertise.	HR Manager
Services provider related risk.	low	Low	ORGANIZATION has already agreement with Telenor Microfinance Bank and account is active. The cash transfer will be given through Cash Transfer through Easy Paisa , Telenor having their outlets and coverage in the project target areas and beneficiaries can receive their cash from these outlets easily.	Finance Manager
Humanitarian Access:				
Delays in receiving NOC / work permission.	Low	Low	ORGANIZATION has already discussed the needs prioritized with Deputy Commissioner Jaffarabad and UCs are also allocated by DC as well, beside this PDMA management is supportive and welcoming to the humanitarian organizations for the response. Furthermore, obtaining of NOC / work permission will not be an issue for ORGANIZATION. ORGANIZATION is also registered with PDMA, and the member of Shelter, WASH, Agriculture and Food Security cluster and attending regular cluster meetings, so this another positive sign for ORGANIZATION	Project Manager
Difficulties in regular and process monitoring owing to restricted access	Medium	Medium	There is an issue in the area due to recent flood, all roads connecting to Jaffarabad are washed away, the movement of staff would be somewhat difficult but not closed any way. ORGANIZATION has implemented large number of project in Jaffarabad District and has active Village Committees/VDMCs/UDMC, from this ORGANIZATION can tackle the situation accordingly, but there is an issue with access, cracks condition of roads that may cause delay in project implementation. ORGANIZATION will work with close coordination of local law and force agencies. ORGANIZATION staff will discuss access issue with ORGANIZATION project management.	Project Manager
Humanitarian space restricts access to beneficiaries due to lockdown / quarantine at homes. Once the government allows/request NGOs assistance they will provide reasonable access to beneficiaries.	Low	Medium	Proper coordinated effort shall be put in place, We shall coordinate with district and relevant authorities	Project Manager

Safety and Security Risks:				
Political Influence	Low	Low	ORGANIZATION will share proper criteria with all stakeholders to avoid any confusions and selection of beneficiaries and project target area. Staff will be oriented on impartiality, neutrality and independence and will ensure that all the process are in line with the humanitarian standards. ORGANIZATION team will arrange meeting with district administration and other stakeholders to keep them aware about transparency in implementation and accountability to beneficiaries.	Project manager
Risk of looting	Low	Low	ORGANIZATION will strictly follow the proper routes and avoid short cuts for the transportation and travel. ORGANIZATION will ensure movement in the day time and avoid travelling in the late evening or in the dark.	Security manager
Anticipated risk of anti-state actors attacks, kidnapping or theft	Low	Low	ORGANIZATION will orient all the staff to take precautionary measure, movement timings and sharing of information with ORGANIZATION dedicated staff / Security Focal person. Team will share plan with senior management to have control of movement ORGANIZATION will remain in contact with local authorities to keep close eye on situation, change indicators and observe the uncertainties and happening in the area.	Security manager
staff mobility and safety issues	Low	Low	Vehicles movement plan will be prepared by the staff and security focal person will be nominated for advising the staff and staff will message through mobile sets on regular basis, every staff will message to security focal person after each hour during the working hours. Office and field timing will be followed strictly by staff.	Admin officer
Office security risk and issues	Low	Low	ORGANIZATION will establish office in safe place, and will hire services of experienced Security Guards for the security and safety of the office. Project Manager and ORGANIZATION management will ensure improved security of the project office.	Security manager
Fiduciary Risks:				
Risk associate to unknown and new appointed staff	low	low	ORGANIZATION will hire staff having good background working with previous organization and their references will also be checked on due required process for hiring of staff. ORGANIZATION will conduct detail orientation session to all project staff regarding project activities and other policies and procedures. ORGANIZATION has all-important policies for implementation of programs and projects included Anti Farad, Accountability and Code of Conduct for the staff and code of conduct for working with communities. ORGANIZATION project / senior management will monitor the process	HR and Project Manager
Fraud Risk in procurements / selection of vendors	Low	Medium	ORGANIZATION has a complaint response mechanism and will ensure that information related to complaints numbers are shared with vendors/supplier/beneficiaries. ORGANIZATION will follow the financial threshold of RF for tender /RFQ and will invite them as observer to procurement process. ORGANIZATION senior management will be involved and the whole process will be documented	Compliant Management officer
There may be risk of fraud and Non-Compliance due to limited monitoring / supervision because of restricted movement in the affected areas.	High	Medium	- RF will maintain an effective internal control over the project, the project will also regularly be monitored by RF team to avoid non-compliance and risk of fraud. - Remote monitoring will used to ensure compliances and supervision shall be provided remotely to partner/staff member. - CRM will be made effective to target area to address the risk of fraud and non-compliances.	Project Manager and all other staff
Conflict of Interest in field office procurements	High	Medium	ORGANIZATION will use separate Bank Account for RF, will define financial threshold, conduct market assessment for potential and reputable vendors, and staff involved in procurements is not given authority to approve or make change in agreements/contract without prior approval of ORGANIZATION senior management ORGANIZATION may purchase the supplies at once from large markets to reduce the risk	Project Manager

2. 5 SAFETY AND SECURITY MANAGEMENT MATRIX/CHECKLIST

A safety and security checklist for a humanitarian project is essential to ensure the safety of humanitarian personnel, beneficiaries, and assets in often challenging and unpredictable environments. This checklist typically includes various measures and protocols to mitigate risks and ensure the security of the project's individuals and resources. Here are some common elements that may be included in a safety and security checklist:

4.5.1 Risk Assessment: Conduct a comprehensive risk assessment to identify potential threats and hazards associated with the project location, including natural disasters, armed conflict, criminal activity, political instability, and health risks such as disease outbreaks.

4.5.2 Security Management Plan: Develop a detailed security management plan that outlines roles and responsibilities, communication protocols, evacuation procedures, and contingency plans in case of emergencies.

4.5.3 Access Control: Implementing access control measures to restrict unauthorized entry to project sites or facilities, such as security checkpoints, perimeter fencing, identification badges, and visitor registration procedures.

4.5.4 Personal Security Measures: Providing training and guidance to personnel on personal security measures, including situational awareness, travel safety, vehicle security, accommodation security, and protective equipment such as helmets and body armor if necessary.

4.5.5 Communication and Reporting: Establish communication channels and mechanisms for staff to report security incidents, receive security updates, and seek assistance if needed. This may include mobile phones, radios, satellite phones, or other communication devices.

4.5.6 Emergency Response: Developing protocols for responding to security incidents, medical emergencies, natural disasters, or other crises, including evacuation procedures, first aid training, and coordination with local authorities or security providers.

4.5.7 Crisis Management: Establish procedures for crisis management and decision-making, including activating emergency response teams, coordinating with relevant stakeholders, and communicating with beneficiaries and other stakeholders.

4.5.8 Cultural Sensitivity and Community Engagement: Promoting cultural sensitivity and respectful engagement with local communities to build trust and minimize security risks. This may include hiring local staff, consulting with community leaders, and adapting project activities to local customs and traditions.

4.5.9 Information Security: Protecting sensitive information, such as beneficiary data, project plans, and financial records, from unauthorized access, theft, or misuse.

4.5.10 Continuity Planning: Developing contingency plans to ensure the continuity of project activities in the event of disruptions caused by security incidents, logistical challenges, or other unforeseen circumstances.

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Examples of safety and security measures implemented in humanitarian projects around the world:

South Sudan: In conflict-affected areas of South Sudan, humanitarian organizations have implemented security measures such as armed escorts for aid convoys, restricted movement protocols, and fortified compounds to protect staff and assets from armed attacks and banditry.

Somalia: In Somalia, where insecurity and piracy pose significant risks to humanitarian operations, organizations have established strict security protocols for staff movement, including the use of armored vehicles, armed guards, and communication escorts when traveling in high-risk areas.

Syria: In Syria, where the ongoing conflict has led to widespread violence and displacement, humanitarian organizations have developed community-based security initiatives to engage with local communities, build trust, and mitigate security risks through dialogue, conflict resolution, and community policing efforts.

Haiti: Following the 2010 earthquake in Haiti, humanitarian agencies implemented security measures such as perimeter fencing, security lighting, and security patrols to protect temporary shelters and distribution sites from theft, looting, and violence.

Ebola Response in West Africa: During the Ebola outbreak in West Africa, humanitarian organizations implemented strict infection prevention and control measures to protect healthcare workers and prevent the spread of the virus, including the use of personal protective equipment (PPE), hand hygiene protocols, and isolation and treatment facilities for infected patients.

Overall, safety and security measures are critical components of humanitarian projects, helping to ensure the safety and well-being of personnel and beneficiaries and enabling organizations to deliver assistance effectively in challenging and often volatile environments. Safety and security management is a collective responsibility, and it involves participation by every person working on the project. The project Manager, security focal point, HR officer, data collection staff, security guards, and social mobilizers all are involved in the security and safety management of staff, assets, equipment, installations, and all distribution items, and office consumables such as food and nonfood items, the warehouse, and the staff houses. All members of the project exercise a duty of care towards all staff. This commitment needs to be visible. Throughout the management line. Team members should use each other as resources, for example, sharing travel briefings.



Chris Gagnon/Concern Worldwide

2. 6 HUMAN RESOURCE PLAN FOR HUMANITARIAN PROJECTS

A Human Resource Plan for a Humanitarian Project describes the tactics and protocols for overseeing project personnel. It encompasses various aspects such as recruitment, training, deployment, performance management, and ensuring the well-being of staff.

A human resource plan that is especially suited for humanitarian projects looks like this checklist:

2.6.1 Needs Assessment:

- Identify project goals and objectives.
- Determine the staffing requirements to achieve project objectives.
- Assess the skills, qualifications, and experience needed for each role.
- Consider cultural and language requirements when working in diverse communities.

2.6.2 Recruitment and Selection:

- Develop job descriptions for each role.
- Advertise vacancies through appropriate channels.
- Establish a recruitment process that includes screening, interviewing, and reference checks.
- Ensure compliance with local labor laws and organizational policies.

2.6.3 Training and Development:

- Design training programs to address skill gaps and enhance staff capacity.
- Provide orientation to the project, organization, and relevant policies and procedures.
- Offer specialized training in areas such as safety and security, first aid, and cultural sensitivity.

2.6.4 Deployment and Onboarding:

- Develop deployment plans for staff, considering logistics and travel arrangements.
- Provide necessary resources and support for staff in the field.
- Facilitate integration into the project team and local community.

2.6.5 Performance Management:

- Establish performance metrics and expectations for staff.
- Conduct regular performance evaluations and provide feedback.
- Resolve performance concerns as soon as possible by coaching, training, or, if required, disciplinary action.

2.6.6 Safety and Security:

- Conduct risk assessments for project locations and activities.
- Develop security protocols and contingency plans.
- Provide security briefings and training for staff.
- Implement measures to ensure the physical and psychological well-being of staff.

2.6.7 Staff Well-being:

- Provide access to healthcare services, including vaccinations and medical treatment.
- Offer counseling and mental health support services.
- Promote work-life balance and provide opportunities for rest and relaxation.
- Establish mechanisms for reporting and addressing concerns related to staff well-being.

2.6.8 HR Policies and Procedures:

- Document HR policies and procedures relevant to the project.
- Ensure compliance with organizational policies, local labor laws, and humanitarian standards.
- Communicate policies and procedures to staff and provide guidance as needed.

2.6.9 Coordinating and Communicating:

- Establish clear lines of communication and reporting within the project team.
- Foster collaboration and coordination among staff members and partner organizations.
- Conduct regular meetings and debriefings to discuss project progress and address challenges.

2.6.10 Monitoring and Evaluation:

- Implement systems for monitoring and evaluating HR-related activities and outcomes.
- Collect feedback from staff to identify areas for improvement.
- Use data and feedback to refine HR strategies and practices throughout the project lifecycle.

By following this checklist, organizations can develop a comprehensive Human Resource Plan that effectively supports the implementation of humanitarian projects while prioritizing the well-being and safety of staff members.



Examples

Concern Worldwide is a global humanitarian organization that operates in various countries, providing assistance to people in need. Here are some general examples of initiatives and projects they might undertake, along with corresponding HR considerations:

Emergency Response Team Deployment: Concern Worldwide often responds to natural disasters and humanitarian crises by deploying emergency response teams. Their HR plan would involve rapid recruitment and deployment procedures, specialized training in disaster response, and measures to ensure the safety and well-being of staff operating in high-risk environments.

Community Development Projects: Concern Worldwide implements long-term development projects aimed at improving the livelihoods of vulnerable communities. Their HR plan would include strategies for recruiting staff with expertise in areas such as agriculture, healthcare, education, and water and sanitation, as well as ongoing training and capacity-building initiatives to support sustainable development outcomes.

Healthcare Programs: Concern Worldwide operates healthcare programs in various countries, providing medical assistance to populations affected by conflict, poverty, and disease. Their HR plan would involve recruiting qualified healthcare professionals, ensuring compliance with medical standards and regulations, and implementing protocols for infection control and patient care.

Gender Equality and Social Inclusion Initiatives: Concern Worldwide places a strong emphasis on promoting gender equality and social inclusion in all of its projects. Their HR plan would include measures to recruit staff from diverse backgrounds, provide training on gender-sensitive programming, and ensure that marginalized groups have equal access to employment opportunities and participation in project activities.

These examples illustrate how a Human Resource Plan for a humanitarian project must be tailored to the specific context, objectives, and challenges faced by the organization and the communities it serves.

2.7 PROCUREMENT PLANS

A Humanitarian Procurement Plan is a strategic document that outlines the procurement process and procedures specifically tailored for humanitarian organizations or agencies. These plans are designed to ensure that goods, services, and equipment required for humanitarian operations are acquired efficiently, transparently, and ethically, while also meeting the needs of affected populations.

Procurement of products (e.g., medicines, food, or non-food items) and services (e.g., transportation, warehousing, and data collection and analysis) is a critical activity for HOs. Falasca and Zobel (2011) report that about 65% of HOs' expenditures are related to procurement activities, with 15% allocated to transportation, 10% to personnel, and 10% to administration.

Humanitarian Organizations' procurement efforts include pre-positioning supplies procured in advance of a disaster and procurement of additional supplies immediately after the disaster. A disaster creates a huge sudden demand spike for specific goods. If HOs fail to procure efficiently and effectively, the needs of affected people may not be met. There may be several reasons HOs may struggle to procure items effectively, such as not having the flexibility to adapt to constantly changing needs and circumstances, facing delays, acquiring expensive products or services, receiving low-quality products, facing procurement fraud, and having limited budgets. HOs' failure to procure the required products can lead to frustration among beneficiaries and loss of trust among donors.

Stringer/Reuters



Key components of a Humanitarian Procurement Plan may include:¹⁶

2.7.1 Needs Assessment: Identifying the specific needs of the affected population, which could range from necessities like food, water, shelter, and medical supplies to specialized equipment and services. Develop technical details of goods and services required (e.g. technical specifications, Bill of Quantities, design/drawing etc.) and prepare cost estimates.

2.7.2 Market Analysis: through your procurement department, assess the availability of goods and services in the local, regional, or global market to determine the best sources of procurement.

2.7.3 Supplier Selection: Identifying reliable suppliers, vendors, or service providers who can deliver the required goods or services within the specified time frame and at competitive prices. In case of urgent need for emergency goods, materials, services etc., the organization may float the request for quotation to already pre-qualified or previous suppliers – after getting waiver from the organizational management or/and respective funding donor.

2.7.4 Procurement Procedures: Establishing and implementing clear procedures for the procurement process, including request for proposals (RFPs), tendering, bidding, and contract negotiations.

2.7.5 Ethical Considerations: Ensuring that procurement practices adhere to ethical standards, such as fairness, transparency, accountability, and compliance with legal and regulatory requirements.

2.7.6 Risk Management Plan: Identifying and mitigating potential risks associated with procurement, such as supply chain disruptions, fraud, corruption, or conflicts of interest. Put in place the response plan to anticipated risks.

2.7.7 Monitoring and Evaluation: Establishing mechanisms to monitor the procurement process, physically verify the goods/material against the pre-agreed specification and criterion, track expenditures, evaluate supplier performance, and assess the effectiveness of procurement activities. Deals with exceptions e.g. low quality, delays in supplies, prices inflation etc.

2.8 DISTRIBUTION PLANS

A Humanitarian Distribution Plan is a strategic document that outlines the systematic and organized process for distributing humanitarian aid, supplies, and services to affected populations during emergencies, crises, or disasters. These plans are crucial for ensuring that aid reaches those in need efficiently, effectively, and equitably, while also addressing logistical challenges and security concerns.

What is distribution:

- *The action of sharing something among several recipients.*
- *Distribution refers to the process of delivering or dispersing products, goods, or services to consumers or end users.*

Types of Distribution in NGOs:

Direct distribution: This involves NGOs distributing aid or relief materials directly to the beneficiaries or communities in need. NGOs may set up distribution centers or temporary sites where individuals can directly collect the resources they require.

Indirect distribution: NGOs may also distribute aid or support indirectly through local partner organizations or community-based groups. These partners have a better understanding of the local context and can ensure that the distribution is targeted and reaches those who need it the most.

Cash-based transfers: Instead of distributing physical items, NGOs may provide cash or vouchers to beneficiaries. This empowers individuals to make their own purchasing decisions based on their specific needs and priorities.

What are the Distribution Steps?

- *Warehousing*
- *Transportation*
- *Order/Goods/Services processing*
- *Inventory management*
- *Packaging and labelling*
- *Channel management*
- *After-delivery service*

What documents are needed for pre and post-distribution activities

- | | |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| • <i>Distribution Plan</i> | • <i>Receipt Acknowledgment</i> |
| • <i>Beneficiary List</i> | • <i>Distribution Reconciliation</i> |
| • <i>Release Order</i> | • <i>Receipt Acknowledgment</i> |
| • <i>GDN/Waybill</i> | • <i>Distribution Reconciliation</i> |
| • <i>Goods Received Note (GRN)</i> | |

Key features of a Humanitarian Distribution Plan may include:

Here's a checklist for humanitarian aid distribution of food packages for refugees and internally displaced people affected by floods:

2.8.1 Assessment and Planning:

- Conduct an assessment of the affected population to determine the scope and scale of food needs.
- Identify vulnerable groups, including women, children, the elderly, and disabled individuals.
- Develop a distribution plan based on assessed needs, considering logistics, distribution points, and timing.

2.8.2 Coordination:

- Coordinate with relevant stakeholders, including government agencies, NGOs, and community leaders.
- Establish communication channels for coordination and information sharing.
- Ensure alignment with local authorities and humanitarian coordination mechanisms.

2.8.3 Food Procurement and Packaging:

- Procure food items suitable for the affected population, considering cultural preferences and dietary requirements.
- Ensure food items are nutritious, non-perishable, and easy to distribute and prepare.
- Package food items in secure and durable packaging to prevent spoilage and contamination.

2.8.4 Logistics and Distribution:

- Arrange transportation for food items from storage facilities to distribution points.
- Set up distribution sites in accessible locations for affected populations. Deploy trained staff to manage distribution processes, including registration, verification, and crowd control.
- Implement measures to maintain order and prevent incidents of violence or unrest during distribution.

2.8.5 Registration and Verification:

- Establish procedures for registering beneficiaries and verifying their eligibility for assistance.
- Use identification cards, registration forms, or biometric technology to ensure accurate and transparent beneficiary data.
- Conduct assessments to identify and prioritize vulnerable individuals or households.

2.8.6 Distribution Process:

- Organize distribution sessions with clear instructions and schedules for beneficiaries.
- Ensure equitable distribution of food packages based on family size and needs.
- Provide information on the contents of food packages, storage instructions, and safe handling practices.
- Offer assistance to individuals with special needs or mobility issues.

2.8.7 Monitoring and Evaluation:

- Monitor the distribution process to ensure compliance with established procedures and standards.
- Collect feedback from beneficiaries on the quality and adequacy of food assistance.
- Conduct post-distribution surveys or assessments to evaluate food assistance's impact and identify improvement areas.

2.8.8 Safety and Security:

- Implement measures to ensure the safety and security of staff and beneficiaries during distribution activities.
- Coordinate with local authorities and security forces to mitigate risks and address security concerns.
- Provide training to staff on security protocols and emergency response procedures.

2.8.9 Community Engagement:

- Engage with affected communities to gather feedback, address concerns, and promote accountability.
- Foster community participation in decision-making processes related to food distribution.
- Raise awareness about the availability of food assistance and encourage participation among eligible beneficiaries.

2.8.10 Documentation and Reporting:

- Maintain accurate records of beneficiaries, distribution dates, and quantities distributed.
- Document any challenges or incidents encountered during the distribution process.
- Prepare regular reports on food distribution activities, including progress, achievements, and challenges encountered.
- By following this checklist, humanitarian organizations can ensure the effective and efficient distribution of food packages to refugees and internally displaced people affected by floods while prioritizing the dignity and well-being of beneficiaries.

Stringer/Reuters



2.9 ADAPTIVE MANAGEMENT DURING HUMANITARIAN PROJECT MANAGEMENT:

Adaptive management is an iterative approach to project or program management that emphasizes flexibility, learning, and adjustment based on monitoring and evaluation findings and changing circumstances. It involves continuously assessing progress, adapting strategies and actions, and integrating new knowledge to improve outcomes and increase resilience in dynamic and uncertain environments.

WHAT IS ADAPTIVE MANAGEMENT, AND WHAT ARE THE TRIGGERS FOR ADAPTIVE MANAGEMENT?

Adaptive Management is defined by USAID as an intentional approach to making decisions and adjustments in response to new information and changes in context.” Adaptive management is not about changing goals during implementation, it is about changing the path being used to achieve the goals in response to changes¹⁷. Around the world, there are people affected by conflict and disaster who do not receive the aid they need – and many more receive no aid at all. Evaluations of humanitarian action show that this is not simply a problem of funding but a problem of flexibility.

As humanitarian needs and situations change, and as our understanding of complex problems evolves, humanitarian agencies must be able to adapt.

TRIGGERS FOR PROJECT ADAPTION:

- *Quality,*
- *Scale up or Down (initial scale of crises over estimated, needs assessment inappropriate, situation stabilizes and the relief activities can be scale down, an additional event exacerbated needs.), population movements demands to scale up)*
- *Contextual changes (security situation changes/ conflict escalates, changes in location is necessary due to population movements, changes in the markets lead to improved/worsened situation)*

Change in strategic priorities (community needs have changes, between project design and start, other agencies have start delivering the same services, more nuanced needs are uncovered during project monitoring, reorientation of resources as new situation arises

- *Stope project (the security situation has deteriorated, funding has been stopped and project staff has been evacuated)*
- *On the one hand, the project documents should not be unchangeable regardless of the changing project reality. On the other hand, care should be taken not to make changes to the project without going through the proper processes and channels.*

Project managers need to establish norms that allow them to flexibly incorporate project changes, when necessary, but they also need to make sure that proposed project changes are managed through a rigorous, integrated change control process that ensures that any project changes are:

- *Managed through a formal change management process*
- *Analyzed to ensure that implications of those changes are thoroughly thought through.*
- *Documented to illustrate their complete impact on all the integrated elements of the project.*
- *Communicated to key project stakeholders*

Once it is clear what level of authority is required, per the project charter, to make decisions on a project change request, the next step is to answer the following additional questions:

- *Have project stakeholders been consulted regarding the proposed change?*
- *Anticipatory, adaptive and reactive approach to change management*

EXAMPLES OF ADAPTIVE MANAGEMENT IN HUMANITARIAN PROJECTS:

Healthcare Programs in Conflict Zones:

In conflict-affected areas, healthcare providers often face challenges such as security risks, population movements, and changing health needs. To address these challenges, humanitarian organizations employ adaptive management approaches by regularly assessing the security situation, adjusting service delivery strategies, and reallocating resources to meet emerging health needs.

Disaster Response and Recovery Efforts:

Following natural disasters such as earthquakes or floods, humanitarian agencies implement adaptive management strategies to respond to evolving needs and priorities. For example, they may modify distribution plans based on changing access constraints, revise shelter designs to better withstand environmental hazards, or adapt livelihood support programs to match shifting market conditions.

Climate Change Adaptation Projects:

Climate change adaptation projects often require adaptive management approaches due to the uncertain and evolving nature of climate impacts. For instance, in coastal communities vulnerable to sea-level rise and storm surges, adaptation measures such as mangrove restoration or flood-resistant infrastructure may need to be adjusted over time based on new climate projections, ecological feedback, and community input.

Food Security Interventions in Agricultural Communities:

In agricultural communities facing food insecurity due to factors such as drought or crop failure, adaptive management is crucial for enhancing resilience and livelihoods. Organizations working in these contexts may employ adaptive strategies such as promoting diversified cropping systems, providing access to climate-resilient seeds, or facilitating community-based early warning systems to anticipate and mitigate future risks.

These examples illustrate how adaptive management principles are applied in diverse humanitarian contexts to address uncertainties, respond to changing conditions, and improve the effectiveness and sustainability of interventions over time.

A growing body of evidence indicates that aid agencies are most successful when operating flexibly, particularly in fragile environments. Yet our systems and tools are often too rigid to address complex problems effectively, and program incentives frequently undermine adaptation instead of supporting it.

To drive improvements in impact, we need to be better able to analyze the dynamics of a given situation, anticipate how these might evolve, and be sufficiently agile to adapt to changes in context and need.

In 2015, the IRC and Mercy Corps joined forces to launch ADAPT (Analysis Driven Agile Programming Techniques) to research, innovate, and field test adaptive management techniques for the sector.



2.10.1 INCLUSION (AGDM AND DO NO HARM APPROACH) IN HUMANITARIAN PROJECTS:

2.10.1 AGE, GENDER, DISABILITY, AND MINORITY INCLUSION CRITERIA IN HUMANITARIAN PROJECTS.

Age, gender, disability, and minority inclusion criteria are factors considered in humanitarian project management to ensure that the needs and perspectives of diverse groups within affected populations are addressed effectively. Here's an explanation of each criterion and how they can be applied in humanitarian projects, along with examples:

Age Inclusion Criteria:

Age inclusion criteria involve considering the needs and vulnerabilities specific to different age groups within the affected population, such as children, adolescents, adults, and the elderly.

In humanitarian projects, age inclusion criteria may involve designing interventions tailored to meet the needs of specific age groups, such as child-friendly spaces in refugee camps, education programs for adolescents, or healthcare services for the elderly.

Example: UNICEF's programs provide nutrition, education, and protection for children in conflict-affected areas, like the provision of safe spaces for play and learning.

Gender Inclusion Criteria:

Gender inclusion criteria focus on addressing the distinct needs, roles, and vulnerabilities of women, men, girls, and boys within the affected population. Gender inclusion criteria in humanitarian projects may involve ensuring equitable access to resources and services, promoting gender equality, and addressing gender-based violence.

Example: The Women's Refugee Commission's initiatives advocating for the protection and empowerment of refugee women and girls, including programs to prevent and respond to gender-based violence.

Disability Inclusion Criteria:

Disability inclusion criteria involve considering the needs and rights of persons with disabilities within humanitarian responses, including access to services, facilities, and participation in decision-making processes. In humanitarian projects, disability inclusion criteria may involve providing accessible infrastructure, services, and information and promoting the participation of persons with disabilities in program design and implementation.

Example: Handicap International's projects focus on inclusive disaster risk reduction and emergency response, ensuring that persons with disabilities have equal access to assistance and support during crises.

Minority Inclusion Criteria:

Minority inclusion criteria involve addressing the needs and rights of ethnic, religious, linguistic, and other minority groups within the affected population, including protection from discrimination and violence. In humanitarian projects, minority inclusion criteria may involve ensuring the representation and participation of minority groups in decision-making processes and tailored interventions to address their specific vulnerabilities and needs.

Example: Minority Rights Group International's projects advocating for the rights of minority communities affected by conflict or displacement, including initiatives to document human rights violations and promote dialogue and reconciliation. Incorporating these inclusion criteria in humanitarian project management helps ensure that interventions are responsive, equitable, and respectful of the diversity within affected populations, ultimately contributing to more effective and sustainable outcomes.



2.10.2 THE DO NO HARM APPROACH IN HUMANITARIAN PROJECTS

The "Do No Harm Approach" (DNH) throughout various phases of humanitarian project management is crucial for ensuring that projects are implemented sensitively and effectively to meet the needs of diverse stakeholders. Here's how participants can apply these principles across different phases:

Needs Assessment Phase:

Inclusion Criteria: During needs assessment, participants can apply inclusion criteria by ensuring that data collection methods are inclusive and representative of the diversity within the affected population. This may involve using participatory approaches, collecting disaggregated data based on age, gender, disability, ethnicity, and other relevant factors, and actively engaging with marginalized groups to understand their needs and perspectives.

Do No Harm Approach: Participants can apply the DNH approach by assessing potential risks and unintended negative consequences of humanitarian interventions during the needs assessment phase. This includes identifying power dynamics, conflicts, and vulnerabilities within the community and taking measures to mitigate harm and promote positive outcomes.

Project Design Phase:

Inclusion Criteria: In the project design phase, participants can ensure that project objectives, activities, and outcomes are informed by the inclusion criteria identified during the needs assessment. This involves designing interventions that address different stakeholder groups' diverse needs and priorities, including marginalized and vulnerable populations.

Do No Harm Approach: Participants can integrate the DNH approach into project design by conducting a conflict analysis and risk assessment to identify potential sources of tension, discrimination, or exclusion. They can then design interventions that minimize these risks and promote social cohesion, equity, and respect for diversity.

Implementation Phase:

Inclusion Criteria: During project implementation, participants can apply inclusion criteria by actively involving diverse stakeholders in decision-making processes, ensuring representation and participation of marginalized groups in project activities, and providing equal access to project benefits and services.

Do No Harm Approach: Participants can implement the DNH approach by continuously monitoring project activities and outcomes to identify any unintended negative impacts or conflicts that may arise. They can then take corrective action to address these issues and prevent further harm.

Monitoring and Evaluation Phase:

Inclusion Criteria: In the monitoring and evaluation phase, participants can use inclusion criteria to assess the extent to which project objectives have been achieved for different stakeholder groups. This may involve disaggregating monitoring data by relevant demographic and social characteristics and soliciting feedback from diverse stakeholders to evaluate project effectiveness and inclusiveness.

Do No Harm Approach: Participants can use the DNH approach to conduct a reflective evaluation of project impacts, considering both intended and unintended consequences on diverse stakeholders. They can document lessons learned, best practices, and areas for improvement to inform future programming and ensure that humanitarian interventions uphold principles of dignity, equity, and non-discrimination.

By applying inclusion criteria and the Do No Harm Approach across different phases of humanitarian project management, participants can enhance project sensitivity, effectiveness, and sustainability, ultimately contributing to positive outcomes for all stakeholders involved.



2.11 MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONNAIRE - DAY II

Q1. What is one of the critical challenges faced in managing projects in the context of humanitarian responses?

- a) Lack of project documentation
 - b) Consistent information flow
 - c) Predictable situations
 - d) Slow decision-making processes
- Correct Answer: b) Consistent information flow

Q2. Which of the following is NOT listed as a document in the Project Documents Checklist?

- a) Technical proposal
 - b) Logical Framework
 - c) Stakeholder Agreement
 - d) Monitoring and Evaluation Plan
- Correct Answer: c) Stakeholder Agreement

Q3. What is the purpose of a Gantt chart in project management?

- a) To summarize key project points
 - b) To track project expenditures
 - c) To visually represent the project plan over time
 - d) To identify potential project risks
- Correct Answer: c) To visually represent the project plan over time

Q4. What is the function of a Risk Assessment and Management Matrix in humanitarian project management?

- a) To identify and capture potential project risks
 - b) To summarize key project milestones
 - c) To outline detailed implementation steps
 - d) To track project expenses
- Correct Answer: a) To identify and capture potential project risks

Q5. Which document outlines the plan for achieving the project's intended results?

- a) Logical Framework
 - b) Project Budget
 - c) Technical Proposal
 - d) Monitoring and Evaluation Plan
- Correct Answer: c) Technical Proposal

Q6. What is the purpose of a safety and security checklist in a humanitarian project?

- a) To increase project efficiency
 - b) To ensure the safety of personnel and assets
 - c) To streamline communication protocols
 - d) To manage project budgets effectively
- Correct Answer: b) To ensure the safety of personnel and assets

Q7. Which element is NOT typically included in a safety and security checklist for humanitarian projects?

- a) Risk Assessment
 - b) Access Control
 - c) Financial Management
 - d) Emergency Response
- Correct Answer: c) Financial Management

Q8. What is the focus of a Human Resource Plan for a humanitarian project?

- a) Procurement procedures
 - b) Safety and security protocols
 - c) Oversight of project personnel
 - d) Financial management
- Correct Answer: c) Oversight of project personnel

Q9. Which component is NOT included in the Human Resource Plan checklist for humanitarian projects?

- a) Needs Assessment
 - b) Supplier Selection
 - c) Staff Well-being
 - d) Performance Management
- Correct Answer: b) Supplier Selection

Q10. What is a key feature of Adaptive Management in humanitarian projects?

- a) Strict adherence to initial project plans
 - b) Resistance to change
 - c) Flexibility and learning based on monitoring and evaluation findings
 - d) Rigid decision-making processes
- Correct Answer: c) Flexibility and learning based on monitoring and evaluation findings

Q 11. How does the "Do No Harm Approach" contribute to humanitarian project management?

- a) By prioritizing project budgets
 - b) By ensuring inclusivity and sensitivity to diverse stakeholders
 - c) By focusing on rapid implementation without assessment
 - d) By minimizing communication efforts
- Correct Answer: b) By ensuring inclusivity and sensitivity to diverse stakeholders.



DAY III

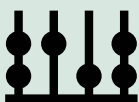
- Participants know how to use monitoring data for project management adjustments.
- Participants can recognize triggers for the project's adaptation and considerations for implementing change.
- Participants understand quality delivery of projects (roles and responsibilities of project team members in quality management)
- Participants know about project communication (stakeholders, roles, timelines).
- Participants can prepare a project closeout plan, sustainability, and exit planning.

3.1 MONITORING OF HUMANITARIAN PROJECTS & USE OF TRIGGERS & INFORMATION FOR ADAPTIVE MANAGEMENT

Over the course of a project, the information needs of internal and external stakeholders vary for a variety of reasons, including accountability, compliance, reporting, learning, and adaptive management. The information required by these stakeholders should be provided by the monitoring, evaluation, accountability, and learning, or MEAL, system at the level of statistical reliability, detail, and timing appropriate to guide data use.

3.1.1 The 5'Cs of MEAL System

At its most fundamental, a project MEAL system should enable us to:



Count the items, goods, participants, events, and people involved for internal and reporting purposes and for internal donor accountability.



Check progress against indicators, assumptions, and beneficiaries' satisfaction, possible changes in context, etc. for adaptive management and learning purposes.



Confirm results on indicators and Theory of Change assumptions at key points. in time ... for donor reporting and for project-based and broader learning



Change strategies and/or actions as necessary to address challenges and improve results (this is what adaptive management is about).

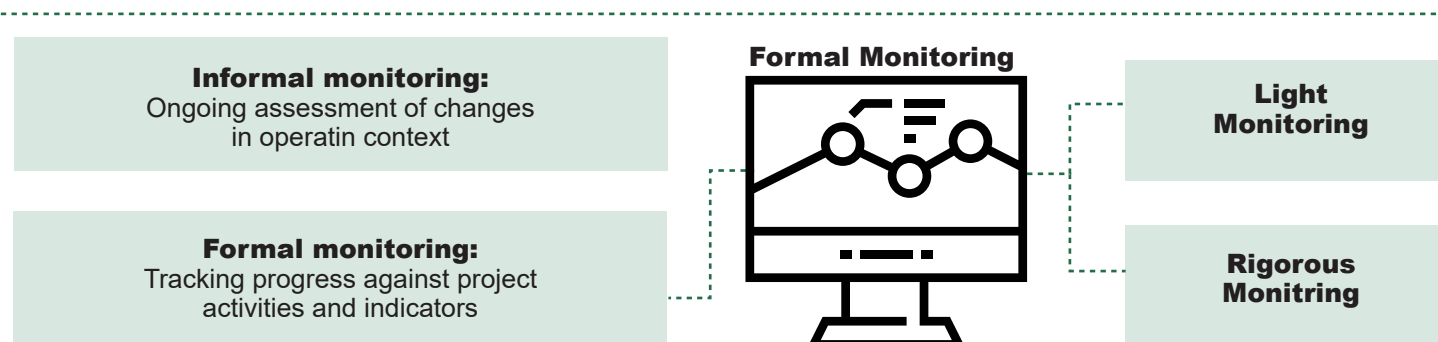


Communicate donors and other pertinent parties of the (proposed) changes stakeholders (consult or inform)¹⁹



In emergency contexts where the situation is still fluid, ‘informal monitoring’ has proved helpful to staff’s ongoing assessment of the broader environment to identify changes in the situation, in other actors’ responses, and in priority unmet needs that would require corresponding changes in the response.

The same distinction between informal monitoring of possible changes in the project’s operating context—whether identified as project assumptions and risk factors or not—and formal monitoring of the activities included in the response and project indicators, is relevant for development contexts too.



Types of Formal Monitoring (Light monitoring and Rigorous Monitoring)

Within formal monitoring, it is useful to further differentiate between light monitoring and rigorous monitoring:

Light monitoring: aims to provide timely feedback on new activities (or new locations or target groups) or aspects of the project’s theory of change (activity-to-output or output-to-IR change) logic. That staff are less confident about checking for early signs that progress is being made and assumptions are kept while there is still ample time to make adjustments if necessary.

Light monitoring is “light” in various ways:

- The limited scope of questions which aim to check if any simple problems exist, recognizing that signs of a possible issue may trigger more in-depth monitoring depending on the severity of the issue and the scope of the change required to address it
- Uses simple monitoring methods (not spending much time and effort on data collection)
- Uses small sample sizes or incomplete/partial data sets that cannot be generalized but are ‘good enough’ to anticipate trends and identify potential issues for adaptive project management.
- Integrates these light checks into project activities to the extent feasible, for cost- and time-efficiencies

Rigorous monitoring: aims to collect representative data for evidence-based project management, reporting, and learning, not just at midterm but throughout project implementation.

The table below explains how different types of monitoring could help in adaptive management. This table and the text above is being adopted from CRS monitoring and adaptive management resource booklet.

	Informal monitoring	Formal Monitoring	
		Light monitoring	Rigorous monitoring
Why?	Adaptive management: To check whether there have been any changes in the context that may affect the continued emergency response or development project.	Adaptive management: To check on the relevance and effectiveness of activities: to check beneficiary satisfaction with activities and for signs that progress toward outputs and IRs is being made, to identify possible problems while there is time to further investigate issues (if needed) and to make adjustments (change) as applicable. To check whether the project's critical assumptions seem to be holding true and are sufficient for supporting the project's theory of change	Adaptive management, documentation, and reporting: To provide reliable data on the relevance and effectiveness of activities (count progress toward outputs and confirm light monitoring results against output and IR project indicators) for adaptive management (change), reporting and learning purposes (communicate).
When? How often?	Ongoing, throughout the life of the response or project, as part of all staff's daily work.	Time-bound: Early and for a limited time, based on the activities schedule and project management information needs to support adaptive management. Focus on the early stage of activity implementation, especially if the activity, target group or context is new. Keep monitoring to the minimum needed for problem-solving – adjust frequency based on perceived risk and initial results. Stop checking when activity is complete, adequate evidence is gathered that activity is achieving intended results, or data saturation is achieved.	Ongoing for activity- and some output-level monitoring (counting) until activity is completed. Specific, predefined points in project implementation for most output- and IR-level monitoring. Frequency as per MEAL plan and reporting requirements. Timing based on the activities schedule, usually after select activities are completed.
How much? (sample)	No specific requirements: this happens as part of normal community interactions (i.e. it is convenience sampling).	Use small sample sizes for initial checks of whether there are any issues. Adjust as needed, e.g. investigate further with larger samples if issues are identified. Purposeful sampling of villages where activities are first initiated. Very small, non-probability samples of project participants in those villages. The sampling approach should aim to reveal typical issues that may hinder progress (e.g. selecting communities that performed "worst" at baseline; selecting "critical" cases that are assumed to face most challenges to progress – if they do progress, there is a strong likelihood that the rest of the communities will also progress).	Count: The entire project population; there should be no sampling if the indicator calls for reporting a number. Confirm: Random sampling for quantitative methods (percentage indicators). Aim for a small but representative sample (i.e. higher margin of error than for evaluations). ⁷ Purposeful sampling for qualitative methods (probing why/why not or how questions).
How? (methods and tools)	Mix of direct observation and informal conversations with a range of stakeholders and community members (beneficiaries and non-beneficiaries), based on opportunities. Informal monitoring is not structured (no tool used); it happens as part of routine community interactions.	Most likely, qualitative methods such as semi-structured observations and conversations / semi-structured interviews with project participants and others. May include quantitative methods on a very small, statistically unrepresentative sample of project participants. Often guided by tools from the MEAL system, complemented by qualitative probing questions. Integrate into project activities whenever possible (e.g. check retention of previous session's key messages at start of next session).	Activity monitoring (typically counting) is often based on activity records. Standalone monitoring activities use quantitative methods—such as structured observation, pre- and post-training tests, post-distribution surveys, individual/household interviews, etc. — using tools developed as part of SMILER.8 Qualitative methods (e.g. focus group discussions) to explain findings from quantitative data collection as needed or to measure qualitative indicators as per project MEAL plan.
What to ask What to look for	This is an unstructured process that requires staff to have the right mindset—a healthy curiosity—to look for unanticipated changes in the context. Look for signs, such as displaced people starting to return home to their villages; people talking about new services that the government or another actor is promising; tension between some families or groups within some villages, even if unrelated to the project; misperceptions about project purpose and benefits, etc. Also look for signs of whether project assumptions and risks external to the project appear to be holding true.	Ask and look for evidence of satisfaction with the activities and progress—or lack thereof—against output- and IR-level indicators: e.g. are participants satisfied with the activities or inputs provided? With information provided. With delivery modalities? What is the level of participation of different people and groups in project activities? Have participants gained the knowledge, skills or attitudes promoted? Do participants seem to be using the inputs distributed and applying promoted practices? In all cases, probe: If not, why not? Look for potential unintended impact of project interventions and "do no harm" considerations. Also investigate whether project assumptions appear to be holding true.	Measure results (number or percentage) achieved against project indicators as specified in MEAL plan: How much of what we planned to do has been accomplished? How many people are participating and benefiting? How many people are adopting promoted practices (and which ones)? How much of what type of change is being seen or reported in target households or communities? As relevant, use qualitative methods to probe into why/ why not or how? Also investigate whether project assumptions appear to be holding true.

	Informal monitoring	Formal Monitoring	
		Light monitoring	Rigorous monitoring
Who to ask	Everyone (beneficiaries and non-beneficiaries, local leaders, key informants, partners and other NGOs, government officials, etc.) as opportunities for interaction arise: this is an unstructured, spontaneous process. Record the source of information (i.e. men/women and other relevant demographics/ characteristics)	Participants (and other community members, as applicable). Women and men separately. If known, focus on groups/individuals most likely to give a sense of success or reveal issues (e.g. critical cases).	Data sources identified as per MEAL plan (likely includes men and women; may focus on some subgroups only or disaggregate further for comparative analysis).
Who does it?	All staff (partner, MEAL and non-MEAL) should be engaged in informal monitoring.	Specific CRS and/or partner program or MEAL staff: Most field staff are responsible for conducting some level of light monitoring on their project component. MEAL staff may also be assigned light monitoring responsibilities.	Specific CRS and/or partner program or MEAL staff, as per MEAL plan and roles and responsibilities defined at SMILER+ workshop (data flow map).
Where and how to record findings	Staff document information learned in the field in their field trip reports and/or share verbally during team meetings (see below). Discussion (preliminary interpretation) and decisions are documented in (internal) meeting notes or reports.	Monitoring data are documented in monitoring tools when conducted as standalone light monitoring activities; or in activity records/field notes when integrated with project activities. Preliminary findings, interpretation and decisions are documented in (internal) meeting notes or reports.	Quantitative activity/output data are tracked in a simple Excel database. Output and IR data are recorded in the project Indicator Performance Tracking Table (IPTT) or Partner Indicator Reporting Table (PIRT) completed by partners. Qualitative data are documented in monitoring tools and analysis matrices, and findings documented in reports.
Analysis and interpretation	Create time for debriefing and encourage field staff to share what they hear and see in the community during regular team meetings. * Ensure informal observations are also reported, discussed and interpreted during project review meetings** with staff and partners. Cross-reference and compare what different team members heard or saw. Consider specific characteristics of information source: location(s) and/or person(s). Compare past field reports to see if some observations are recurring	Light monitoring data are analyzed and interpreted during regular* team meetings. Light monitoring findings are also discussed during project review meetings** with staff and partners. Light monitoring data are interpreted together with existing accountability and quantitative activity and output tracking (counting) data. Disaggregate data between men and women (and other relevant demographics/characteristics, e.g. purposeful sampling decisions) Interpret findings within limitations of sample size.	Data analyzed by MEAL staff and PM in preparation for project review meetings** with staff and partners. Comparison groups and data disaggregation as per MEAL and/or analysis plans ⁹ (gender disaggregation at minimum). Probe for correlations between indicators. Quantitative and qualitative monitoring and accountability data are interpreted jointly. Data are interpreted within their level of representation
Use Change and communicate	Appropriate action is taken immediately to further investigate and/or to adjust/ change the response as needed. Preliminary findings may be communicated with key stakeholders and may be documented in project reports as appropriate	Use for problem-solving: appropriate action is taken immediately to adjust activities or approaches as needed. Key findings and decisions may be communicated verbally with donors and are usually documented in project reports. Report findings within limitation of approach (do not generalize findings to all participants or report numbers or percentages); focus communication on action taken to solve problem.	Use data, trends and comparisons for project adaptive management and learning. Use for reporting to donors and other stakeholders. Report percentage within limitation of sampling strategy (margin or error).



3.2 QUALITY DELIVERY OF THE PROJECT

Ensuring the quality of deliverables is paramount in humanitarian project management. Projects are centred around specific objectives and performance standards, with deliverables addressing critical needs within affected communities.

Quality management encompasses planning, assurance, and control processes to guarantee that project outputs meet the desired standards (these could Sphere Project Standards, The Core Humanitarian Standard on Quality and Accountability (CHS),

The project manager plays a crucial role in developing a comprehensive project execution approach that aligns with the humanitarian goals and ensures the delivery of high-quality outcomes. This involves creating a detailed project quality plan outlining each deliverable's expectations and specifications. Documenting these specifications and expectations is vital for clearly understanding project objectives.

Given the dynamic nature of humanitarian work, where needs may change rapidly, flexibility is key. Project specifications may evolve, necessitating adjustments to the execution plan. Changes in quality specifications are managed alongside cost and schedule changes, with careful analysis of their impact and appropriate approvals sought.

3.2.1 Clarification of Roles and Responsibilities among Teams

Roles and responsibilities must be clearly defined to facilitate effective coordination and collaboration within the project team. Tools like the RACI matrix can help delineate who is responsible, accountable, consulted, and informed for each task. This clarity enhances individual accountability, reduces confusion, and fosters a sense of ownership among team members.

In humanitarian settings, where resources and capacities may be limited, defining team roles based on the project's goals and deliverables is essential. By matching skills to specific tasks, project managers can optimize team performance and ensure the efficient delivery of humanitarian aid. Clear role definitions also facilitate delegation, performance assessment, and practical problem-solving, ultimately contributing to the success of humanitarian projects.

3.2.2 How do you decide what roles are needed on a project team?

To define the team roles needed for your project, outline the goals and key deliverables of the project. Think about the skills you need to ensure those deliverables are high quality, and then match and assign team members accordingly.

3.2.3 What are the benefits of defining project team roles?

- *The benefits of clearly defined roles include:*
- *Increase individual accountability.*
- *Reduce confusion and overlap.*
- *Give team members a feeling of ownership and clarity around expectations.*
- *Enable project managers to delegate tasks and assess team members' performance.*
- *Establish a structure for effective problem-solving and collaboration.*

3.2.4 Initiator, Reviewer, and Approver roles and responsibility.

a). Initiator : is the person, who is proposing a change based on the monitoring data, for example monitoring team visited the IDP camp site and observed that tarpaulin sheets distributed by the agency, are no longer suitable as a roofing material because of intense weather conditions including rains and heavier snowfall, and therefore, NFI coordinator is proposing to include corrugated iron sheets, and frames of an angle iron in the winter package to help IDPs use these as roofing material.

b). Reviewer: this could be the shelter coordinator/ shelter advisor or the shelter cluster technical staff, who could further review the number of CGI sheets, type and size of frame, its design and other specification of CGI sheets.

c). Approver: It could be the Project Director / Team Leader who could make approve this change based on budget availability, line-item flexibility, and ultimate discussion with the donor focal point.

The similar example could also be used on certain other areas / matters if monitoring reports are indicating adaptive change required in approach, methodology etc of the emergency.

3.2.5 Here's an example of a quality management plan for a humanitarian project:

Project Title: Emergency Shelter Construction in Refugee Camps

Objective: To provide safe and adequate shelter for displaced populations in refugee camps, meeting international humanitarian standards.

a). Quality Planning:

- *Conduct comprehensive needs assessments to identify shelter requirements, considering climate, terrain, cultural preferences, and family size.*
- *In consultation with experts and stakeholders, develop detailed technical specifications for shelter construction, including materials, design, and structural integrity.*
- *Define acceptance criteria for shelters, including standards for safety, durability, weather resistance, and liveability.*

b). Quality Assurance:

- *Implement a rigorous procurement process to ensure the quality of construction materials and equipment, adhering to relevant standards and regulations.*
- *Conduct regular inspections and quality control checks throughout construction, involving trained engineers and inspectors.*
- *Provide technical training and supervision to local laborers and construction teams to maintain quality standards during implementation.*

c). Quality Control:

- *Establish a system for monitoring and evaluating shelter construction progress, tracking adherence to technical specifications and timelines.*
- *Implement corrective measures to address deviations from quality standards, such as repairing structural defects or replacing substandard materials.*
- *Engage community members and beneficiaries in the quality control process, solicit feedback, and address concerns to meet their needs.*

d). Documentation and Reporting:

- *Maintain comprehensive records of all project activities, including procurement documents, construction plans, inspection reports, and beneficiary feedback.*
- *Report project progress regularly to stakeholders, donors, and humanitarian coordination mechanisms, including quality assurance and control measures.*
- *Document lessons learned and best practices throughout the project lifecycle, informing future humanitarian interventions and quality management strategies.*

e). Risk Management:

- *Identify potential risks to quality management, such as supply chain disruptions, technical challenges, or adverse weather conditions.*
- *Develop risk mitigation strategies to minimize the impact of these risks on project outcomes, including contingency plans and alternative sourcing options.*
- *Continuously monitor and reassess risks throughout the project implementation, adapting strategies to maintain quality standards.*

This quality management plan for emergency shelter construction in refugee camps demonstrates a comprehensive approach to ensuring the delivery of high-quality humanitarian assistance. By prioritizing quality planning, assurance, and control measures, the project aims to meet the shelter needs of displaced populations while upholding international humanitarian standards.

3.3 PROJECT COMMUNICATION FOR EFFECTIVE MANAGEMENT

Project communication management is a crucial aspect of project management as it ensures all stakeholders are kept informed about the project's progress, issues, and changes, thereby facilitating effective decision making and collaboration.

Project communication management is a collection of processes that help make sure the right messages are sent, received, and understood by the right people.

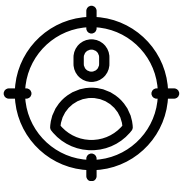
How to create a project communication management plan

Project managers need to clearly outline how they will manage communications across their projects. This is done by creating a project communication management plan.

3.3.1 Five Steps of Effective Project Communication Management



- a) **Decide your objectives:** What will be the purpose of your communication? You may use some communication tools for awareness, such as a status report. Others may require action, such as requiring a sponsor to authorize spending or a customer to approve project testing.



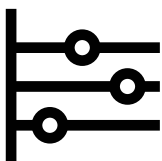
- b) **Determine your audience:** Who are the stakeholders in this project? You should make an extensive list of everyone involved. Consider anyone impacted by the project or who influences its success. This list should include team members, sponsors, customers, and other interested parties.



- c) **Write your message:** What will the message be for each type of communication? This is the actual content that will be shared. Key components to be communicated include scope, schedule, budget, objectives, risks, and deliverables.



- d) **Choose your channel:** How will the message be delivered? Will it be a formal report emailed out to all stakeholders? Or will it be an informal verbal debrief during a team meeting?



- e) **Set a timeline:** When will you deliver your message? Do your stakeholders require weekly or monthly reports? Is there a deadline to meet? Consider varying time zones and employee schedules here.

Project communication management plan should be detailed enough to lay out why you're sending a message, who you're sending it to, what specific information will be sent, how you're going to send it, and when.

3.4. PROJECT SUSTAINABILITY, EXIT PLANNING, AND PROJECT CLOSE-OUT.

Humanitarian Project Sustainability, exit planning, and project close-out are essential to ensure that humanitarian projects achieve their intended long-term impact and are responsibly concluded when appropriate. Let's break down each concept:

3.4.1 Humanitarian Project Sustainability:

Definition: Sustainability refers to the project's ability to maintain its intended benefits over the long term, even after external support has ended.

Key Components:

Community Involvement: Engaging local communities in project design and implementation fosters ownership and commitment. **Capacity Building:** Strengthening local institutions and individuals ensures they have the skills and resources to continue project activities independently.

Resource Mobilization: Identifying and leveraging local resources and partnerships for ongoing support beyond the project's duration.

Example: A clean water project in a rural community may involve training residents to maintain water infrastructure and establishing community water committees to oversee operations.

Sustainability Checklist:

- Engage locals formal and informal bodies (farming communities) in project planning and decision-making.
- Provide comprehensive training to locals (farmers) on sustainable agricultural practices.
- Establish local (farmer cooperatives or associations) to promote knowledge sharing and resource pooling.
- Identify and secure funding or partnerships for ongoing extension services and technical support.
- Monitor and evaluate the adoption of sustainable practices and assess their long-term impact on livelihoods and food security.

3.4.2 Exit Planning:

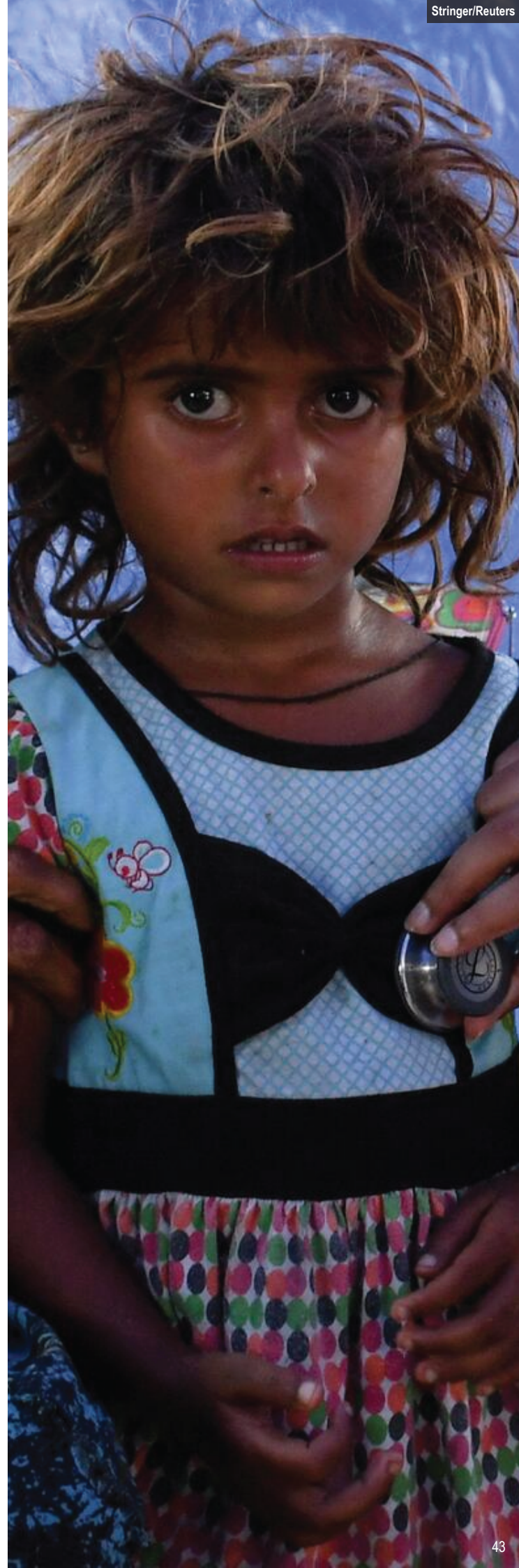
Definition: Exit planning involves developing strategies to transition project responsibilities to local stakeholders and ensuring the project's impact persists after the organization withdraws its support.

Key Considerations: **Capacity Assessment:** Assessing the readiness of local partners to assume project responsibilities independently.

Transition Plan: Developing a phased approach to transfer project management and operations to local entities gradually.

Sustainability Measures: Implementing strategies to ensure the project's sustainability beyond the organization's involvement.

Example: In an education project, exit planning may involve training local teachers and administrators to take over curriculum development and program management.



3.5 MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONNAIRE DAY III:

Q 1. In the context of monitoring humanitarian projects, which of the following is NOT a purpose for which stakeholders require information?

- a) Accountability
- b) Compliance
- c) Donor satisfaction
- d) Adaptive management

Answer: c) Donor satisfaction

Q 2. What is the primary purpose of the MEAL system in humanitarian projects?

- a) To count the number of project beneficiaries
- b) To check progress against indicators and assumptions
- c) To confirm results on indicators at key points in time
- d) To communicate changes to donors

Answer: b) To check progress against indicators and assumptions

Q 3. In the context of quality management in humanitarian projects, what is the role of the project manager?

- a) To approve changes in quality specifications
- b) To ensure compliance with Sphere Project Standards
- c) To develop a comprehensive project quality plan
- d) To conduct regular inspections of project sites

Answer: c) To develop a comprehensive project quality plan

Q 4. What tool can be used to clarify roles and responsibilities within a project team?

- a) Gantt chart
- b) PERT diagram
- c) RACI matrix
- d) SWOT analysis

Answer: c) RACI matrix

Q 5. Who is responsible for proposing changes based on monitoring data in a humanitarian project?

- a) Initiator
- b) Reviewer
- c) Approver
- d) Project manager

Answer: a) Initiator

Q6. Which step of effective project communication management involves determining the purpose of communication?

- a) Decide your objectives
- b) Determine your audience
- c) Write your message
- d) Choose your channel

Answer: a) Decide your objectives

Q 7. What is the primary purpose of a project communication management plan?

- a) To determine the project timeline
- b) To outline how communications will be managed
- c) To assign project roles and responsibilities
- d) To track project budget and expenses

Answer: b) To outline how communications will be managed

Q 8. Which of the following is NOT a key component of project sustainability?

- a) Community involvement
- b) Capacity building
- c) Resource depletion
- d) Monitoring and evaluation

Answer: c) Resource depletion

Q 9. What is the purpose of exit planning in humanitarian projects?

- a) To transition project responsibilities to local stakeholders
- b) To secure additional funding for project extension
- c) To expand project activities to new geographical areas
- d) To monitor project progress against key performance indicators

Answer: a) To transition project responsibilities to local stakeholders

Q 10. What is a key step in project close-out?

- a) Conducting regular project evaluations
- b) Developing a transition plan for local stakeholders
- c) Sharing project findings with relevant stakeholders
- d) Documenting project challenges and successes

Answer: d) Documenting project challenges and successes

3. 6 TRAINING EVALUATION SHEET

S #	Areas/ Questions	Rankings		
		Excellent	Fair	Average
1.	Overall satisfaction with the three days of the training.			
2.	Opportunities and environment to speak and contribute candidly and engage beyond hierarchy.			
3.	Agenda towards the fulfillment of the desired objectives and learning outcomes of the workshop.			
4.	Ice breakers and energizers for creating team building among different branches and entities.			
5.	Quality of training material and training material			
6.	Logistics and administrative arrangements at the training venue including meals, tea, and hospitality arrangements			
7.	Space for group work and plenary sessions			
8.	Clarity on the tasks and questions from the facilitators during group work, teamwork and scenarios.			
9.	Time management and attendance of the training team and facilitators			
10.	The facilitators were skilled and articulate in organizing the learning sessions and group work and creating inclusive opportunities for participants from different organizations			

Please share your thoughts on the improvement of such training in the future.

Would you recommend Himat Consulting and their team for other training and workshops?

Yes?

NO.

Three topics that you want to learn more about from this training.

Pre- and Post-Learning Self-Assessment Form: Humanitarian Project Cycle Management

Name of Organization: _____

Participant Name: _____

Designation: _____

Instructions

Please review the following list of knowledge and skills statements. Consider what you knew before this training and what you learned from the workshop. Rate yourself that best represents your knowledge and skills **before** and **after** this training.

Please fill out the pre-assessment form "Before Training" now. On the last training day, we will share the same paper again and request you to complete the post-assessment form "After Training." You have 10 minutes to complete the assessment form.

RATING SCALE: 1 = POOR 2= FAIR 3 = GOOD 4= VERY GOOD 5 = EXCELLENT

BEFORE TRAINING					SELF-ASSESSMENT OF KNOWLEDGE AND SKILLS RELATED TO:	AFTER TRAINING				
HUMANITARIAN PROJECT CYCLE MANAGEMENT AND PROJECT PERFORMANCE										
1	2	3	4	5	Understanding about humanitarian project cycle management	1	2	3	4	5
1	2	3	4	5	Differentiate between Humanitarian Projects and Programmes	1	2	3	4	5
1	2	3	4	5	Activities required to launch a humanitarian project	1	2	3	4	5
1	2	3	4	5	Critical Aspects of Humanitarian Project Performance	1	2	3	4	5
1	2	3	4	5	Skills and approaches for people management during Humanitarian Project	1	2	3	4	5
TOOLS AND APPROACHES OF HUMANITARIAN PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION										
1	2	3	4	5	Various tools used during project implementation like DIP and Gantt Chart etc	1	2	3	4	5
1	2	3	4	5	Risk Areas and Risk Management Plan for Humanitarian Projects	1	2	3	4	5
1	2	3	4	5	Process and key points of Humanitarian Assistance/ Aid Distribution Plan	1	2	3	4	5
					Process and types of procurement plans					
1	2	3	4	5	Adaptive Management and Triggers of Adaptive Management	1	2	3	4	5
1	2	3	4	5	"AGDM" and "Do NO Harm Approach" application	1	2	3	4	5
HUMANITARIAN PROJECTS MONITORING QUALITY MANAGEMENT, AND CLOSEOUT										
1	2	3	4	5	How and why to monitor Humanitarian Projects	1	2	3	4	5
1	2	3	4	5	How to use monitoring data and information to improve the quality of projects	1	2	3	4	5
1	2	3	4	5	Roles and responsibilities of team/staff in quality assurance of humanitarian projects	1	2	3	4	5
					Sustainability of Humanitarian Projects, and stakeholders' communication					
1	2	3	4	5	Developing an exit plan and a closeout plan for an emergency project?	1	2	3	4	5

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

"Adeel Qaiser holds a Master of Business Administration with a specialization in Project Management. He serves as a Program Development Advisor, Researcher, and Trainer within the humanitarian sector. With an extensive background in designing, implementing, and leading humanitarian projects, Adeel has contributed significantly to efforts in Pakistan, Bangladesh, Myanmar, Yemen, South Sudan, Kenya, and Syria, under the auspices of prominent international non-governmental organizations.

Adeel is a valued member of the Himat Consulting Team and DEW Pakistan. He has evaluated projects and carried out research in a variety of contexts and in a number of different fields, including public health, education, and water, sanitation, and hygiene (WASH). Furthermore, he provides remote program development support to Niger, Mali, Yemen, Sudan, Sri Lanka, and Afghanistan, through his role in the Humanitarian and International Partnership Department of Muslim Hands UK.

Adeel has also been instrumental in designing a third-party monitoring system for the Tameer e Khalaq Foundation, commissioned by UNICEF. His contributions underscore a profound commitment to enhancing the efficacy and reach of humanitarian interventions globally."

ENDNOTES

- 1 https://civil-protection-humanitarian-aid.ec.europa.eu/who/humanitarian-principles_en
- 2 Those lack self capacities and are either more exposed to hazards or deals with negative impacts of disaster
- 3 <https://reliefweb.int/report/yemen/humanitarian-crisis-yemen-seven-years-who-strengthening-health-system-responding-vital>
- 4 <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S2405844023055548>
- 5 https://www.preventionweb.net/files/68257_682306nepaldrmsstatusreport.pdf
- 6 [https://prince2.wiki/extras/what-is-prince2#:~:text=PRINCE2%20project%20variables&text=There%20are%206%20variables%20\(performance,remember%20them%3A%20Use%20TeCQuila%20SoBeR.](https://prince2.wiki/extras/what-is-prince2#:~:text=PRINCE2%20project%20variables&text=There%20are%206%20variables%20(performance,remember%20them%3A%20Use%20TeCQuila%20SoBeR.)
- 7 <https://emergency.unhcr.org/coordination-and-communication/interagency/humanitarian-programme-cycle-iasc>
- 8 <https://antonionietorodriguez.com/humanitarian-project-management/>
- 9 <https://www.disasterready.org/post/top-3-characteristics-of-a-good-project-manager-in-humanitarian-aid>
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- 11 <https://www.careemergencytoolkit.org/management/7-project-management/>
- 12 <https://www.projectmanager.com/blog/implementation-plan>
- 13 <https://www.teamgantt.com/what-is-a-gantt-chart>
- 14 <https://www.wrike.com/blog/what-is-risk-matrix/>
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- 18 https://asksource.info/sites/default/files/ADCAP%20Training_Learner%20Workbook%202017.pdf
- 19 https://www.crs.org/sites/default/files/tools-research/monitoring_for_problem_solving_adaptive_mgt_reporting_and_learning_2020.pdf

TRAINING PARTICIPANTS MANUAL 2024

HUMANITARIAN PROJECT CYCLE MANAGEMENT (HPCM)

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FROM THE AMERICAN PEOPLE



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